

Lecture 7: Mobile Sensing

Chenshu Wu

Department of Computer Science

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香 港 大 學

THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG



Contents

- Mobile Sensors and IMUs
- Sensor Data Processing
- Human Activity Recognition
- Mobile Sensing Applications

Mobile sensing vs. Wireless sensing

- Wireless sensing: Hardware installed somewhere in the space
 - Freedom!
- Mobile sensing: Users need to carry a (mobile) device
 - Goes anywhere!
- A key paradigm shift:
 - Device-based vs. device-free
 - Or Active vs. passive
 - Or Contact-based vs non-contact/contactless

Smartphone & Sensors

- Tell a feature on your phone and identify the enabling sensor
 - E.g., Face ID: RGB camera + infrared camera
- *What are the most critical ones (in your opinions)?*

Smartphone sensors

Accelerometer

- Measures rate of change of velocity along three orthogonal axes of smartphone
- Output: gravitational units (g) or meters per seconds squared (m/s^2); positive or negative depending on the orientation of smartphone

Gyroscope

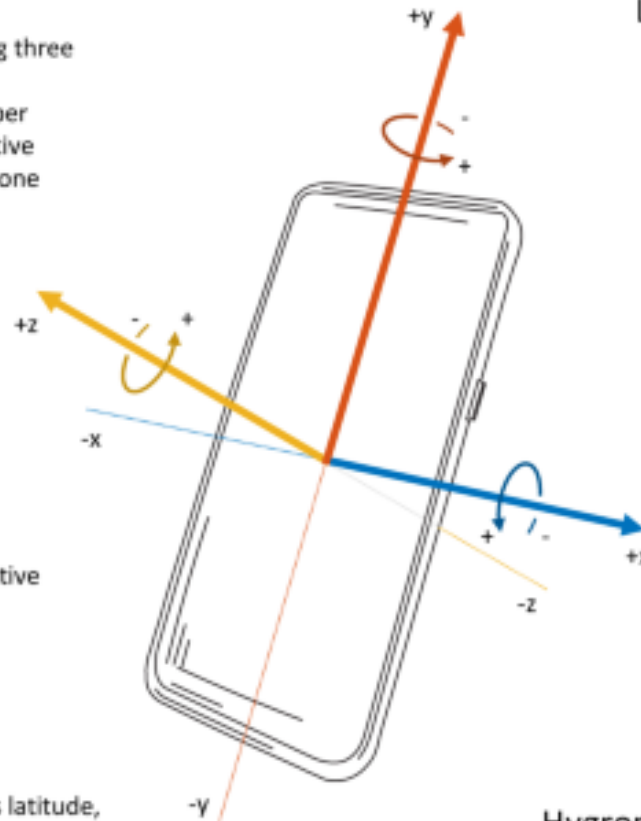
- Measures angular velocity around three orthogonal axes of smartphone
- Output: radians per second (rad/s); positive or negative depending on the direction of rotation

Magnetometer

- Measures strength of Earth's magnetic field relative to three orthogonal axes of smartphone
- Output: microtesla (μT); positive or negative depending on the orientation of smartphone

GPS

- Measures geolocation of smartphone as latitude, longitude, and altitude coordinates on Earth
- Output: decimal degrees ($^{\circ}$)



Light sensor

- Measures ambient light level (illuminance) in front of the sensor (screen)
- Output: lux (lx)

Proximity sensor

- Measures distance between the sensor (screen) and the closest visible object
- Output: centimeters (cm)

Barometer

- Measures atmospheric pressure
- Output: hectopascal (hPa) or millibar (mbar)

Thermometer

- Measures ambient air temperature
- Output: Celsius ($^{\circ}\text{C}$)

Hygrometer

- Measures ambient relative humidity
- Output: percent (%)

Smartphone sensors

Accelerometer

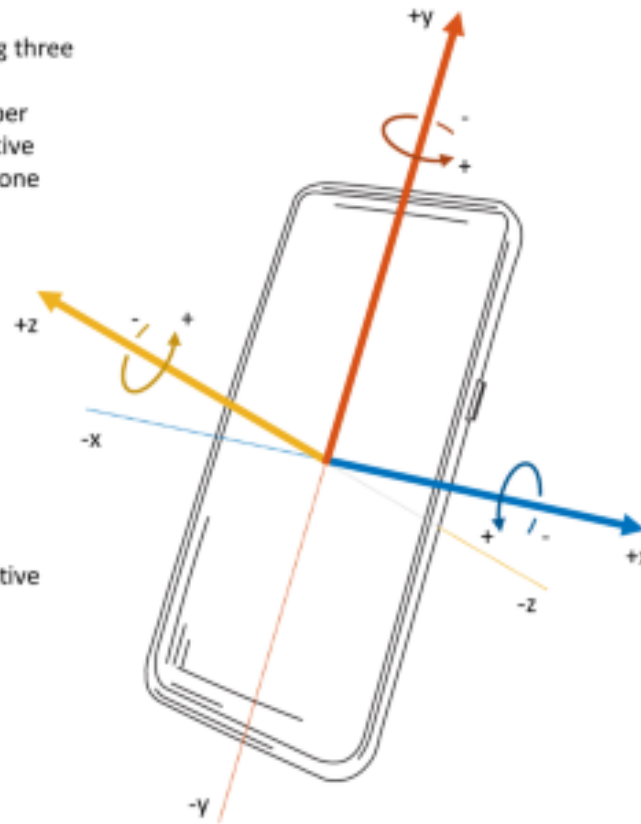
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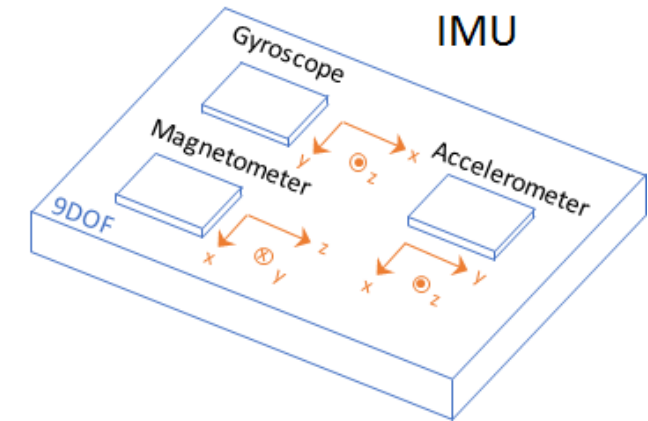


Barometer

- Measures atmospheric pressure
- Output: hectopascal (hPa) or millibar (mbar)

Inertial Measurement Units (IMUs)

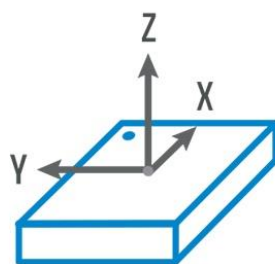
- **Accelerometer**
 - Measures linear acceleration of movement along three axes in m/s^2
- **Gyroscope**
 - Measures angular velocity of rotation along three axes in degrees/s
- **Magnetometer**
 - Measures magnetic field strength in μT (micro-Teslas), indicating orientation



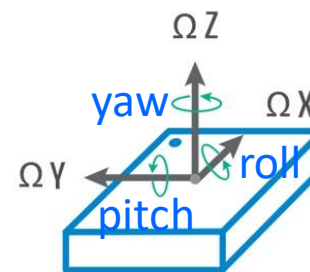
IMUs

- 6 Degree of Freedom (DoF)
 - Three of linear motion (acceleration): x, y, z
 - Three of rotational motion (angular velocity): roll, pitch, yaw

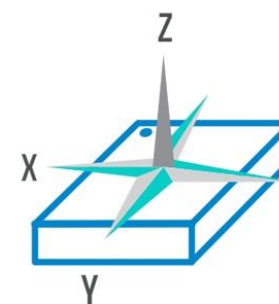
- 9 DoF
 - Fusion of A/G/M
 - Each of 3 axes



Accelerometer



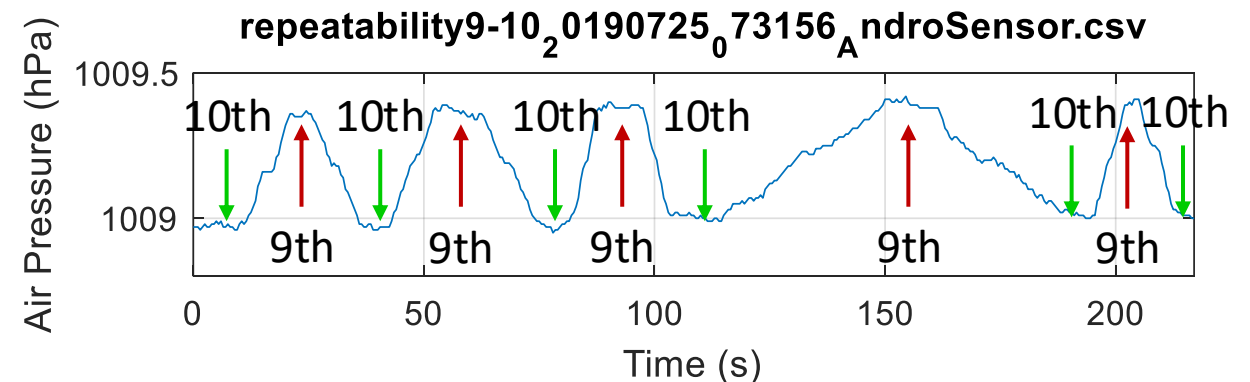
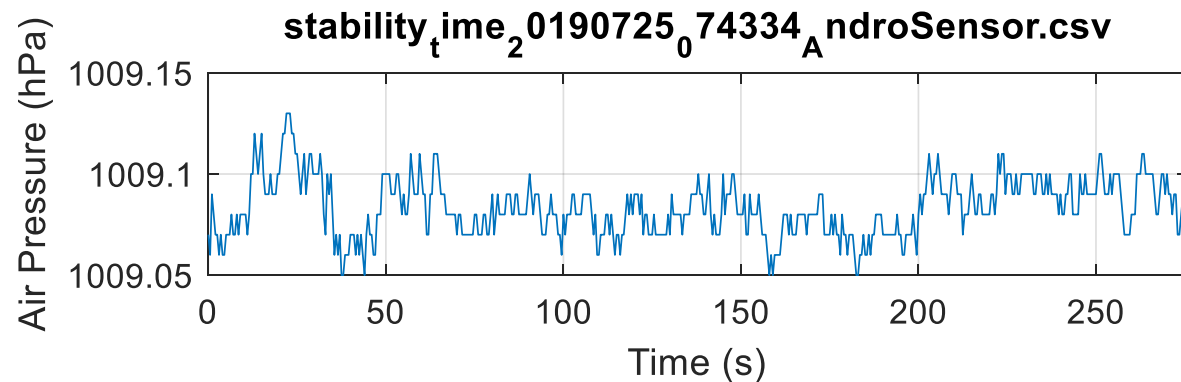
Gyroscope



Magnetometer

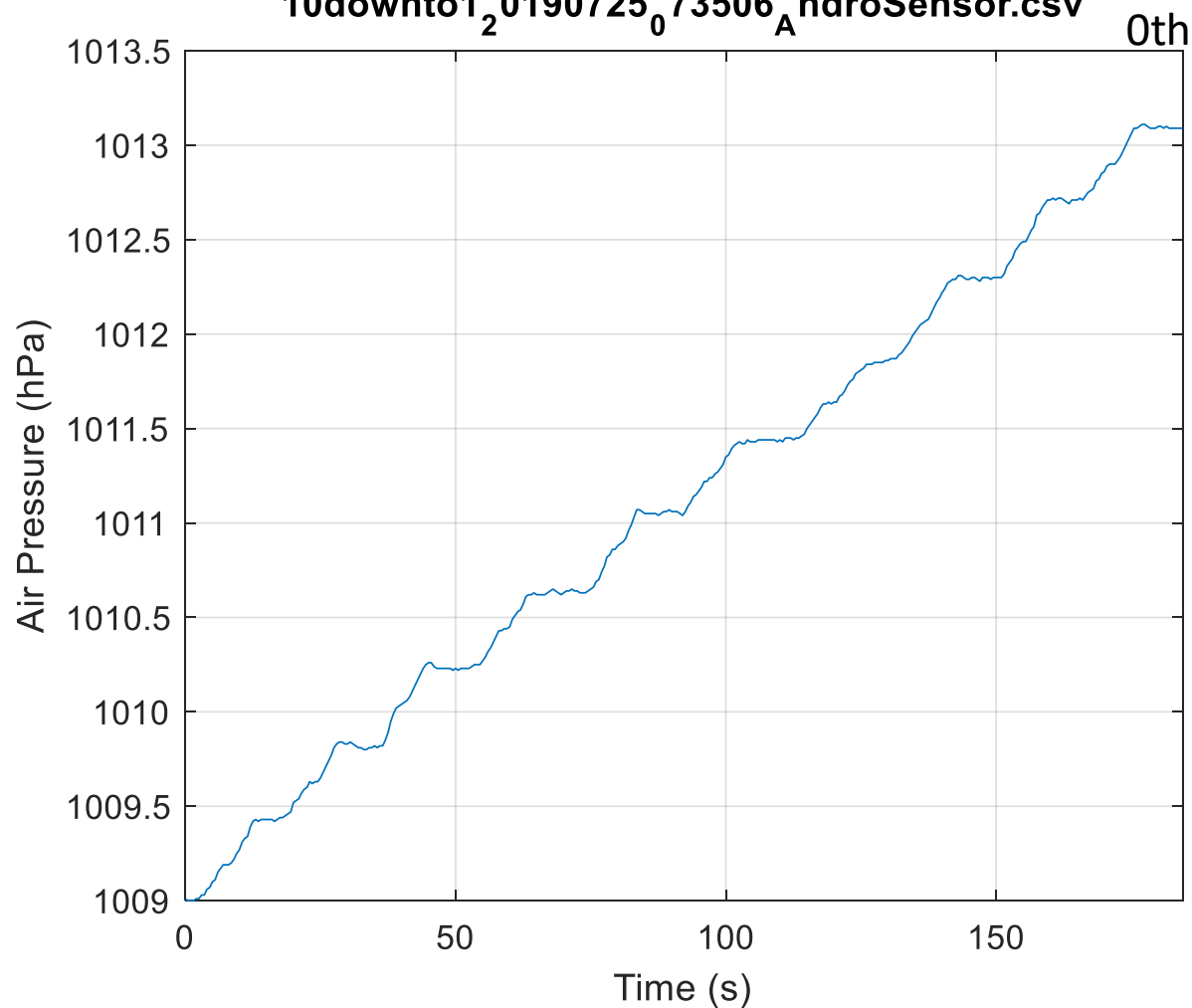
Smartphone Barometer

- Measure atmospheric pressure
 - Can be used to calculate altitude
 - Augment GPS's vertical location
- May not be adequate for absolute altitude estimation, yet sufficient for height change detection
 - Measure pressure difference to infer elevation change

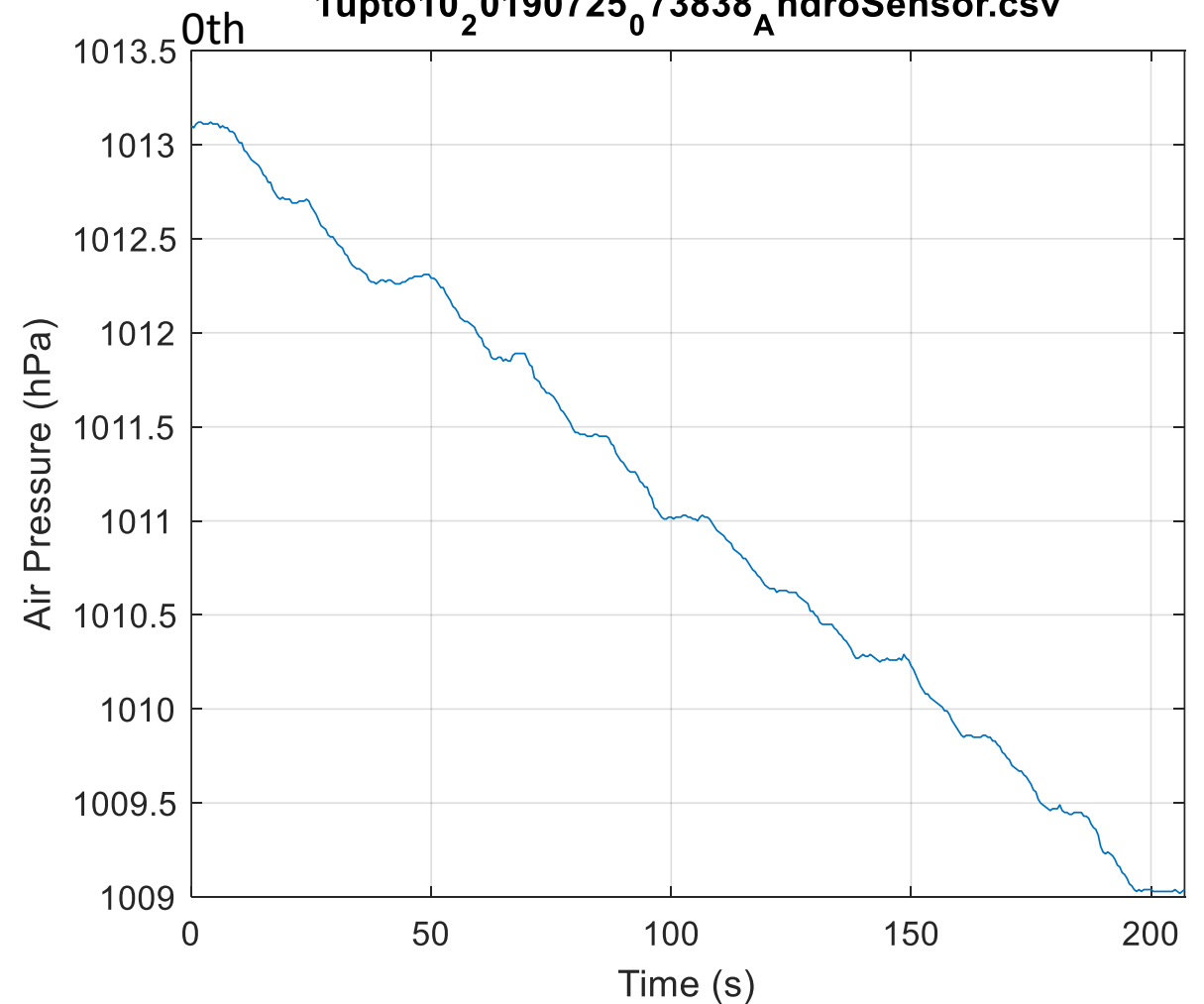


Barometer for floor transition

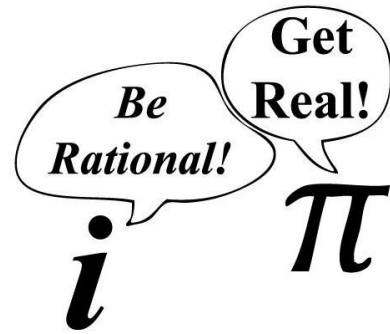
10downto1_2_0190725_073506_A_ndroSensor.csv



1upto10_2_0190725_073838_A_ndroSensor.csv



Get Real and Have Fun!



- Have some fun playing with the real sensors using phyphox
 - Available on iOS/Android



<https://phyphox.org/download/>



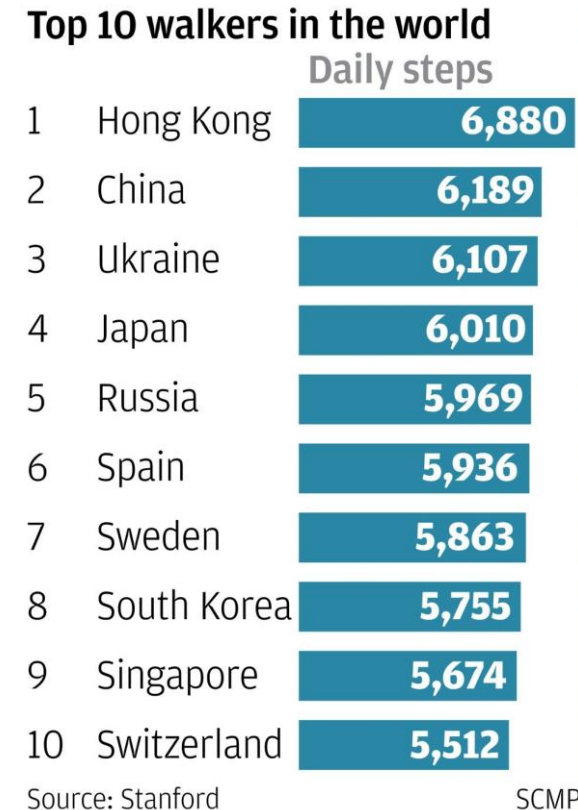
Step Count

- Smartphones and wearables already use IMUs to offer activity indicators
- However, automatic and more refined activity recognition needs more advanced techniques
- *What's your daily average?*



Fun Facts

- Hongkongers walk an average of **6,880** steps a day, making them the most active in the world, a study has found.
- A Stanford University survey in 2007 ranked Hong Kong first out of 46 countries and regions with 6,880 steps a day, compared with a world average of 4,961.



CMHK 11:18 70%

[Back](#)

Top 100 Users

Your rank: 00424 Your steps: 306747

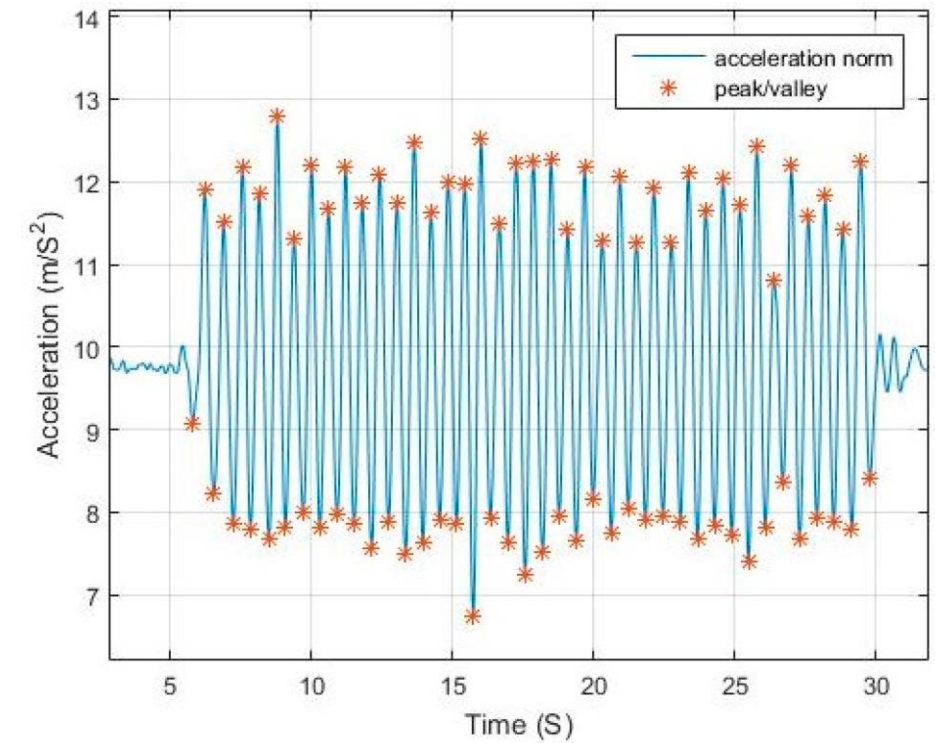
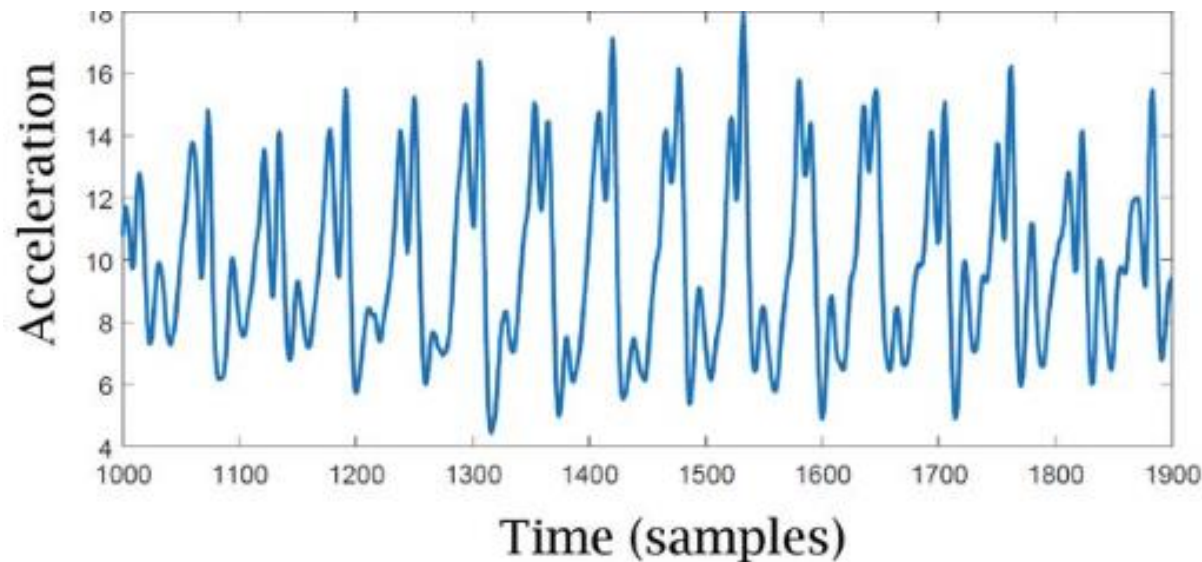
Challenge period: 2022/5/1 00:00 to 2022/6/1 00:00
This page updates every 30 mins. Last update: 2022/6/14 12:56

Rank	Name	Steps
1	????? ?????	1735555
2	Who will be top 5?	1725500
3	Winners announced 10 June	1621129
4	Don't forget to refresh to upload your steps!	1590600
5	????? ?????	1545334
6	Wong Chi Ming	1527574
7	Ahamed Shafi	1503897
8	Mahmood Mushtaq	1497834
9	Jongshan Rana	1493984



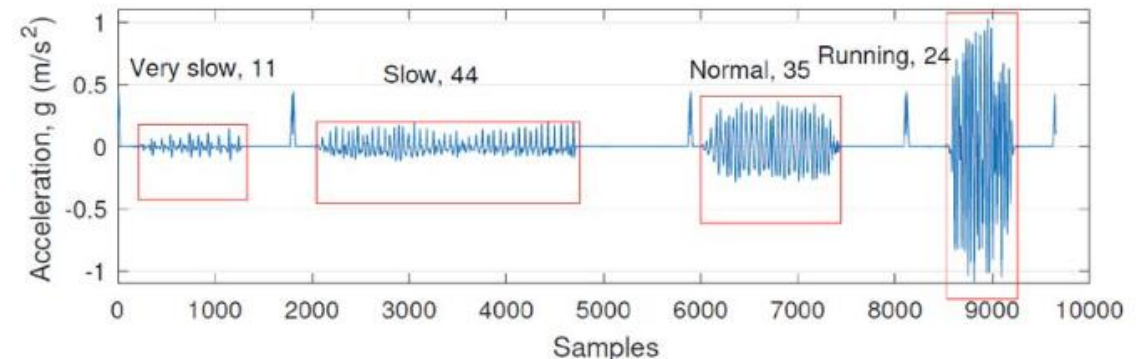
Step Counting

- Walking involves periodic motion sensed by IMU (mainly accelerometer)
 - Walking causes up/down bounce
 - Result in sinusoidal motion in IMU

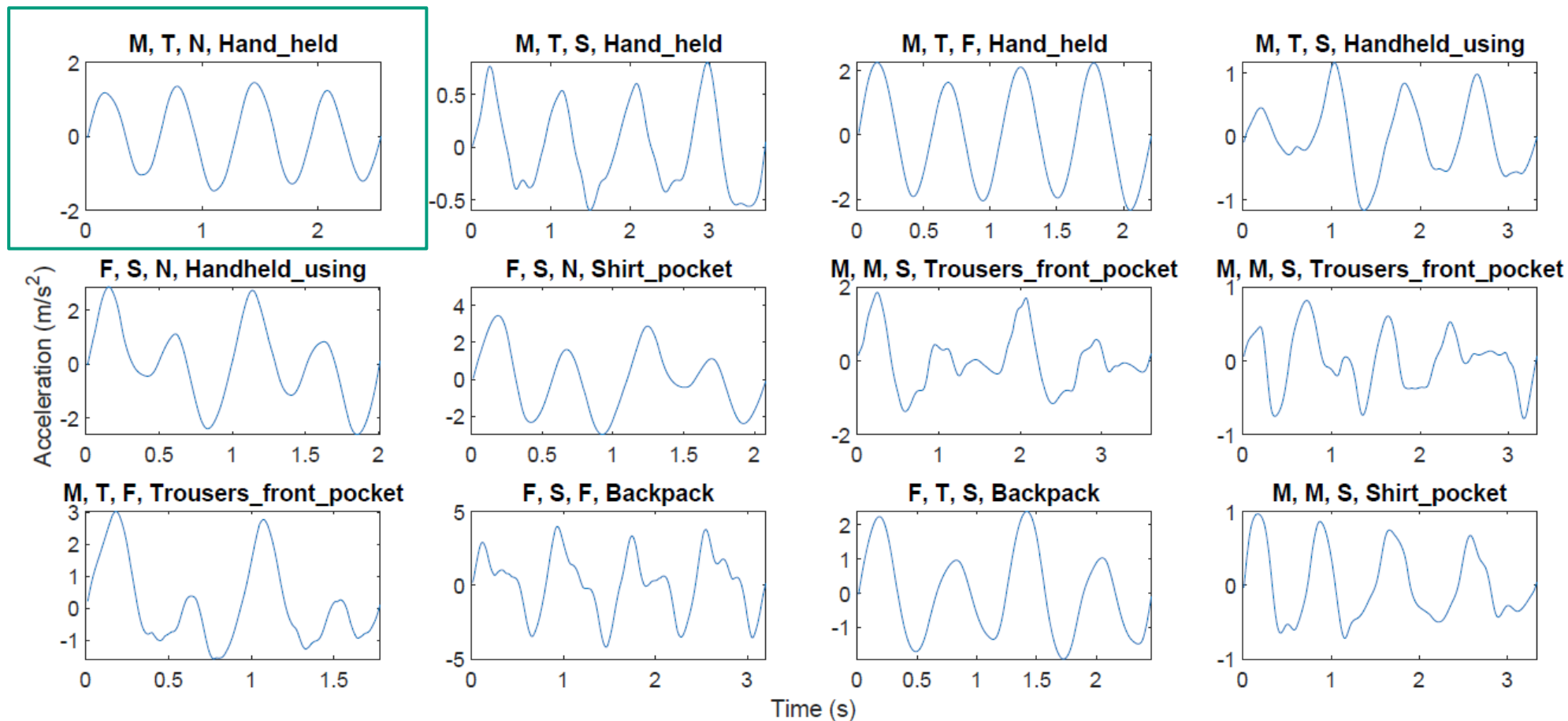


Step Counting

- Methods
 - Zero-crossing, Peak detection, ACF, FFT, ...
- What are the problems?
 - IMU senses the sum of **walking signal** + **all other interference**
 - Unwanted, unintended motions
 - Phone positions and orientations
 - Diverse user behaviors
 - Different walking speeds

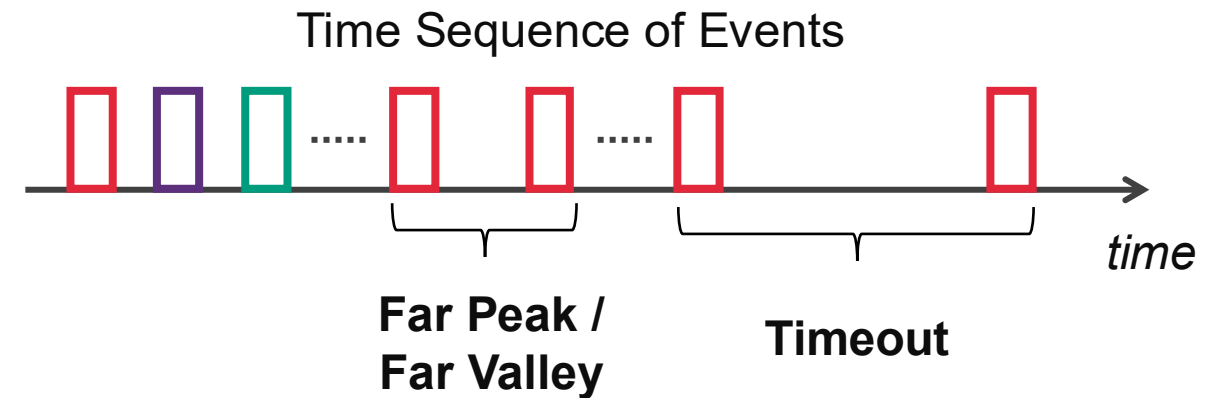
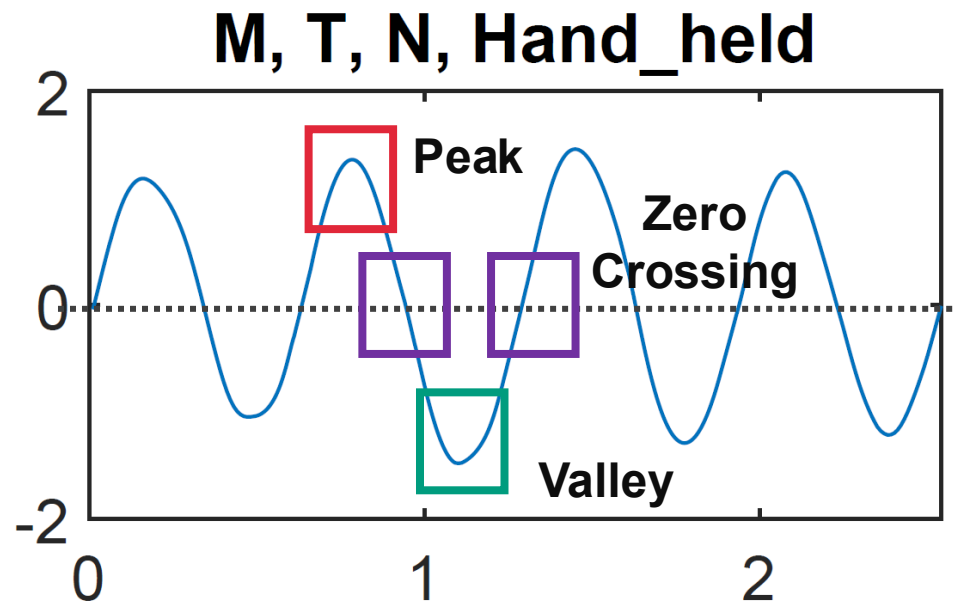
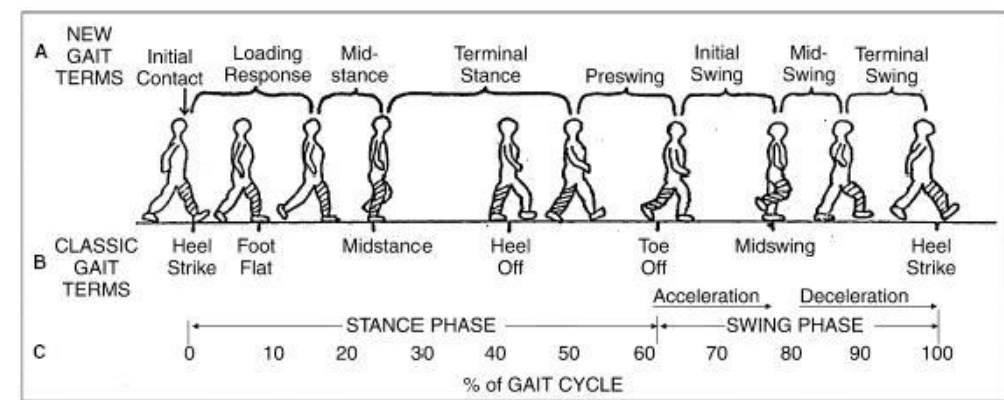


Step Counting

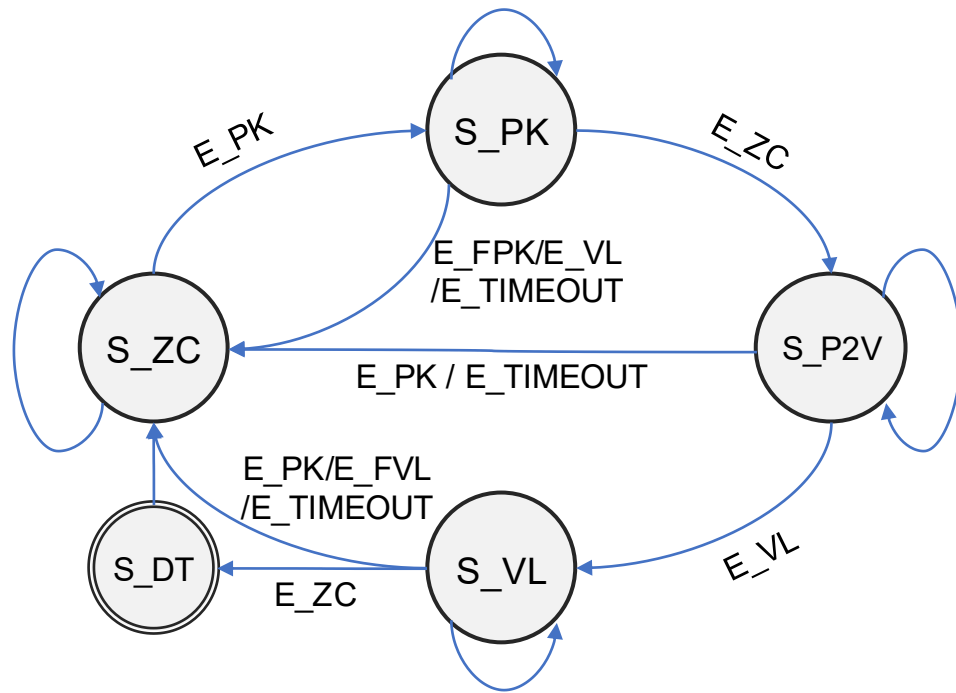


A FSM Approach

- Using a **Finite State Machine** (FSM) to characterize the acceleration transitions during a step cycle
- Transform raw accelerations into **atomic events**



FSM Design

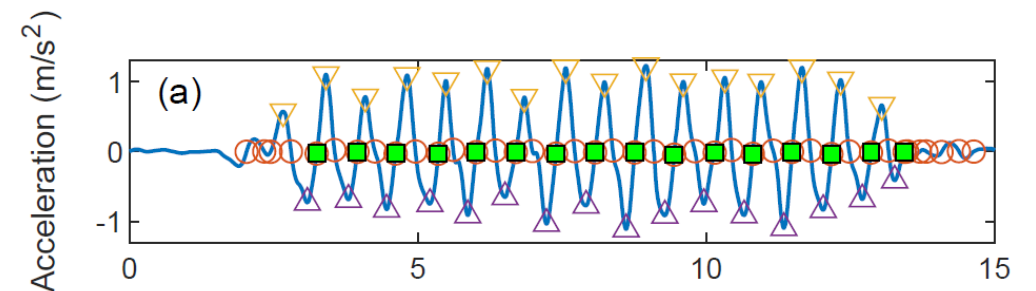
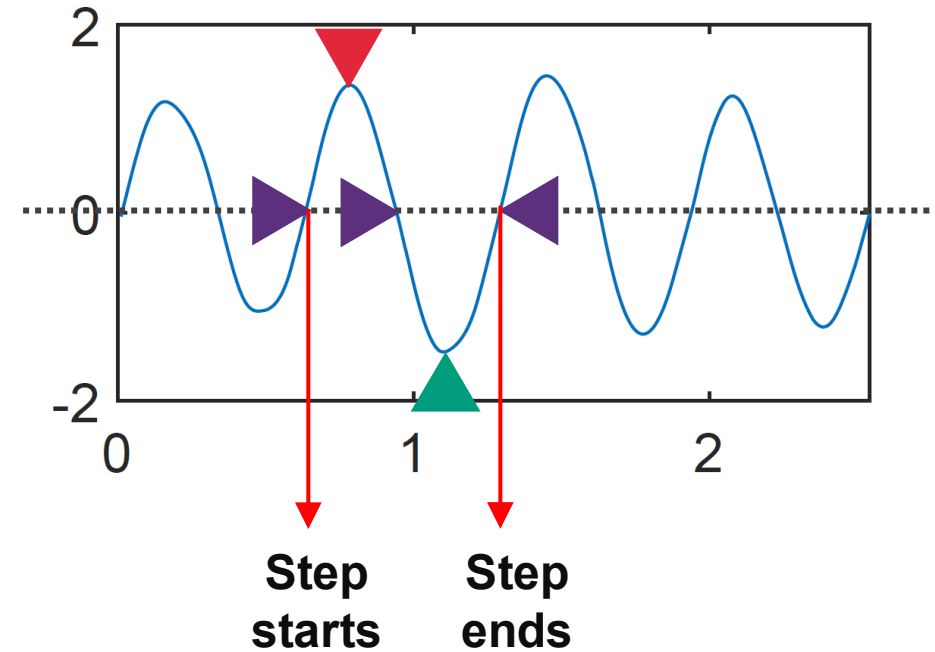


STATES:

S_ZC: Zero Crossing
 S_PK: Peak State
 S_P2V: ZC from Peak to Valley
 S_VL: Valley State
 S_DT: Step Detected

EVENTS:

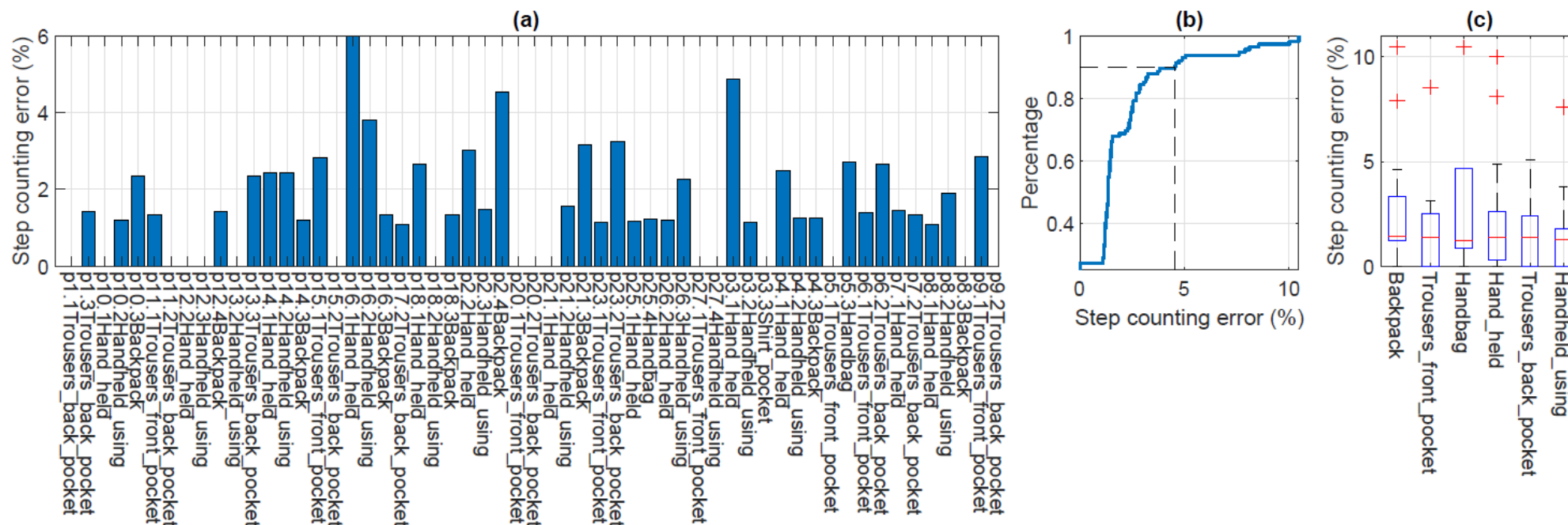
E_PK: Peak detected
 E_VL: Valley detected
 E_ZC: Zero crossing
 E_FPK/E_FVL: Far peak/valley
 E_TIMEOUT: State timeout



Step Count Accuracy

- Public dataset

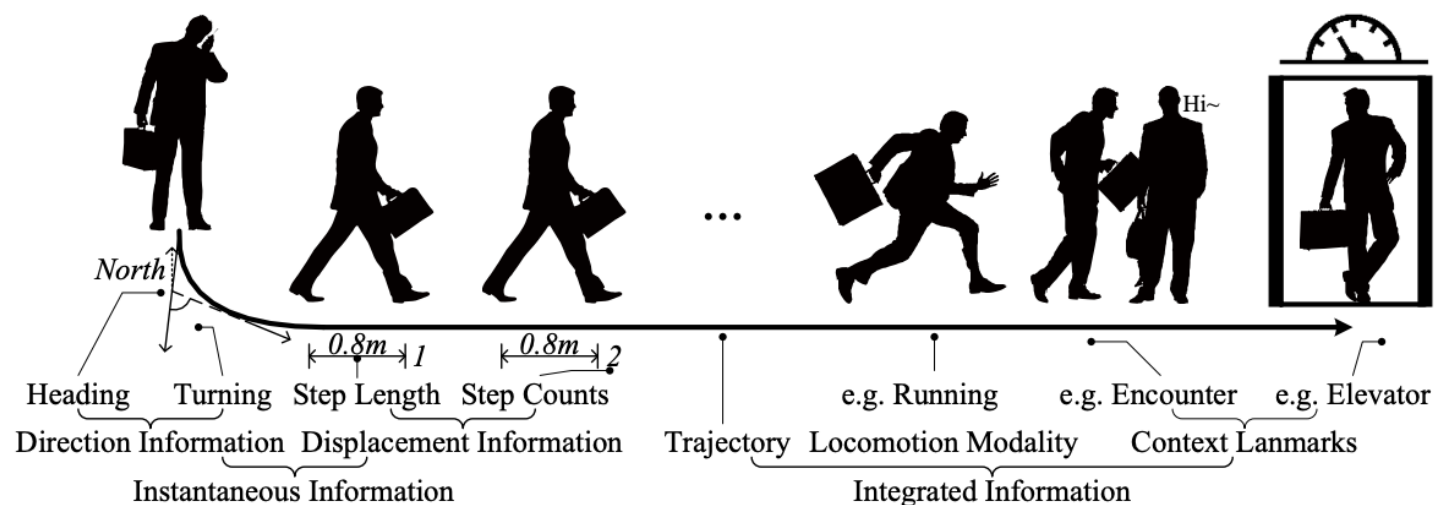
- The step counting errors for most of the traces are within 3%, while the 90%tile error is less than 5%, outperforming all the 9 different approaches evaluated on the same dataset [1].



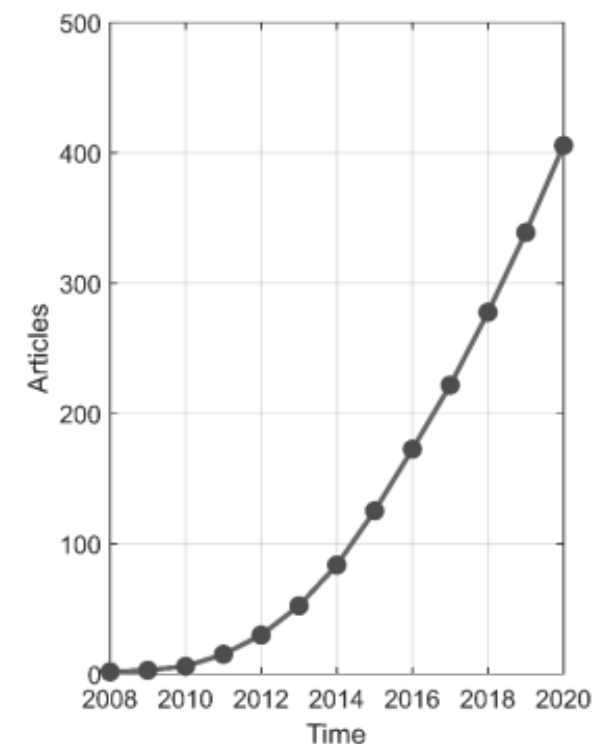
[1] A. Brajdic and R. Harle. Walk detection and step counting on unconstrained smartphones. In Proceedings of ACM UbiComp. ACM, 2013.

Beyond Step Count

- Human activities recognition (HAR)
- Inertial tracking (Dead-reckoning)



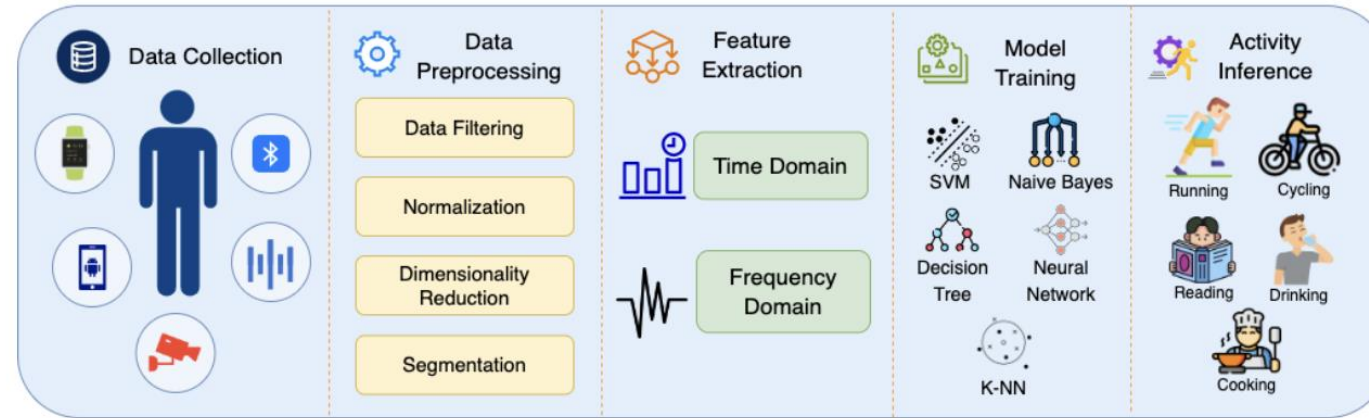
- *A general pipeline of processing?*



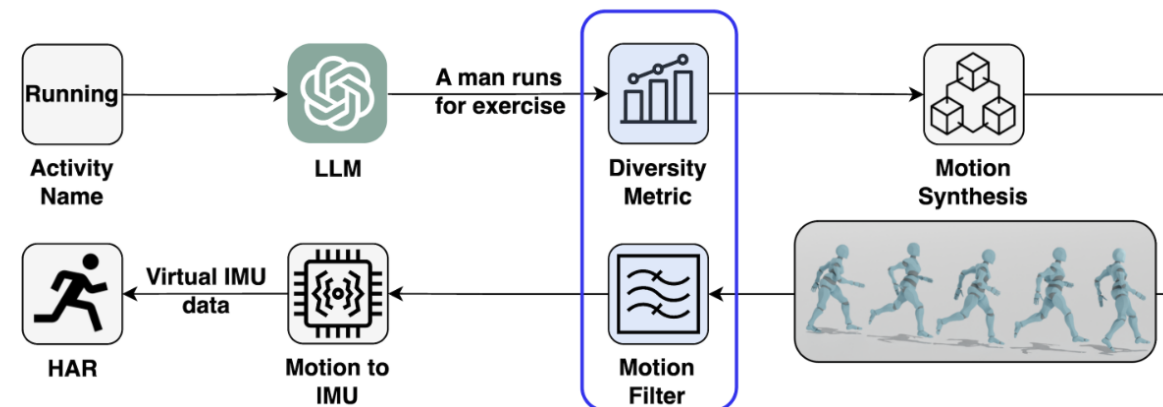
Cumulative number of peer-reviewed articles on human activity recognition (HAR) using smartphones published between January 2008 and December 2020, based on a search of PubMed, Scopus, and Web of Science databases

Human Activity Recognition Framework

Before LLM



After LLM



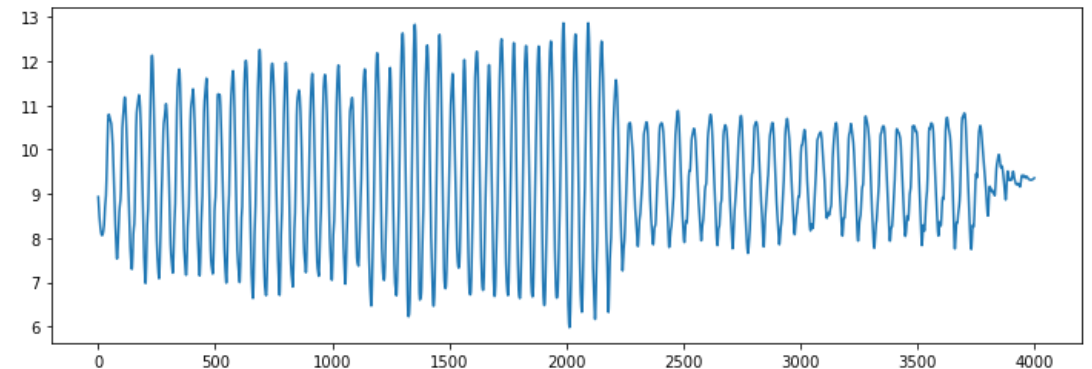
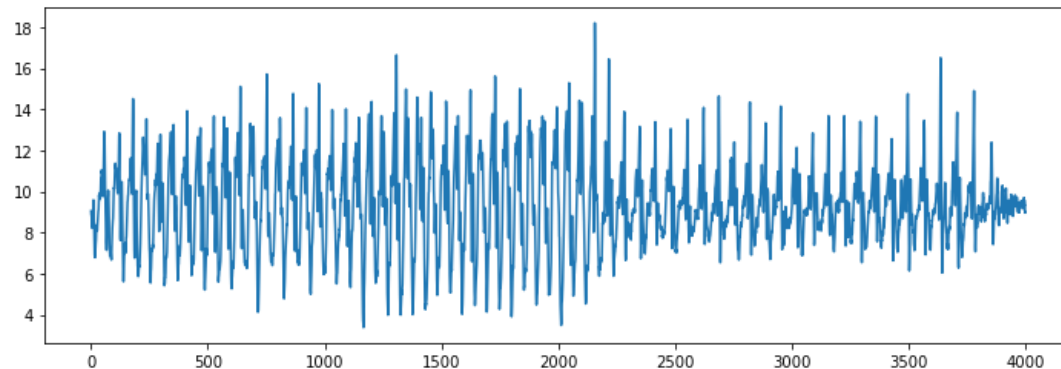
Introduced in IMUGPT 2.0

Sampling

- Generally between 20 to 30 Hz
 - Can be 100 Hz or even higher, depending on the devices and OS
- Sampling rate affects responsiveness
 - (Android API specifications)
 - `SENSOR_DELAY_FASTEST`: best effort
 - `SENSOR_DELAY_GAME`: 20 ms (50 Hz)
 - `SENSOR_DELAY_NORMAL`: 200 ms (10 Hz)
 - `SENSOR_DELAY_UI`: 60 ms (~17 Hz)
- Sampling rate affects battery life
 - A lower sampling rate is preferred, especially for long-term, background data collection

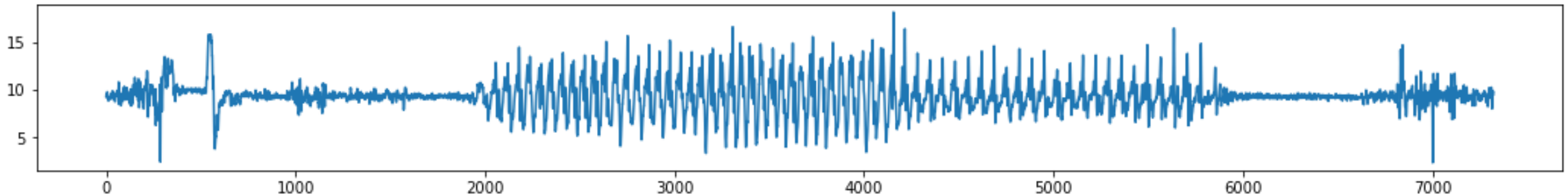
Filtering

- Remove certain (unwanted, known) frequencies
 - “known”: Some prior knowledge of unwanted frequencies to design the filter
- Example
 - Low-pass filter: pass low frequencies and attenuate high frequencies
 - Band-pass filter: pass only frequencies in a frequency band



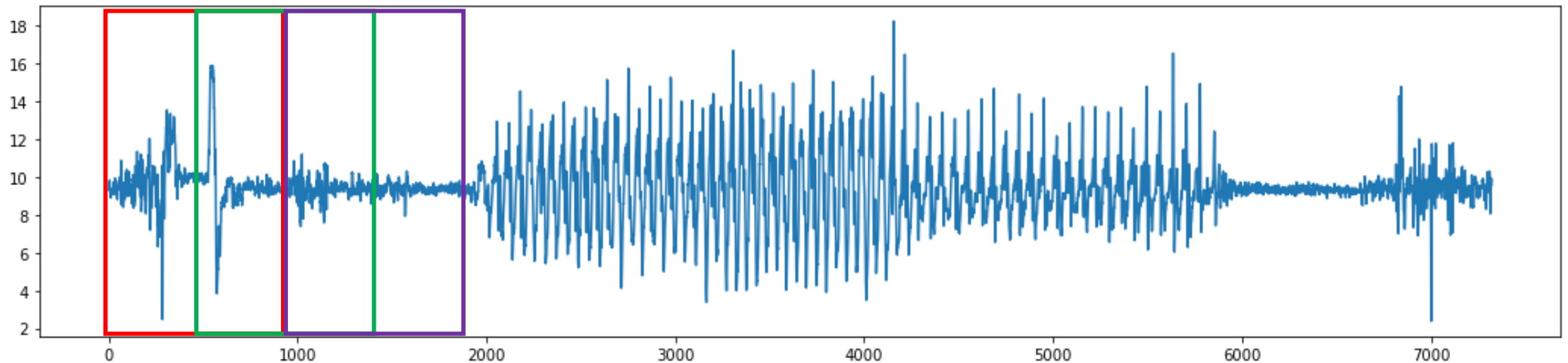
Windowing

- Pick a segment of the sensory time series for processing
 - How to localize some temporal patterns of interest?
 - Where to start/stop and what they are?
- Apply a window for Data Segmentation
 - Break down streaming data into segments for processing
 - Sliding window approach
 - Window length, overlap, window label...
 - Window-based preprocessing, global preprocessing



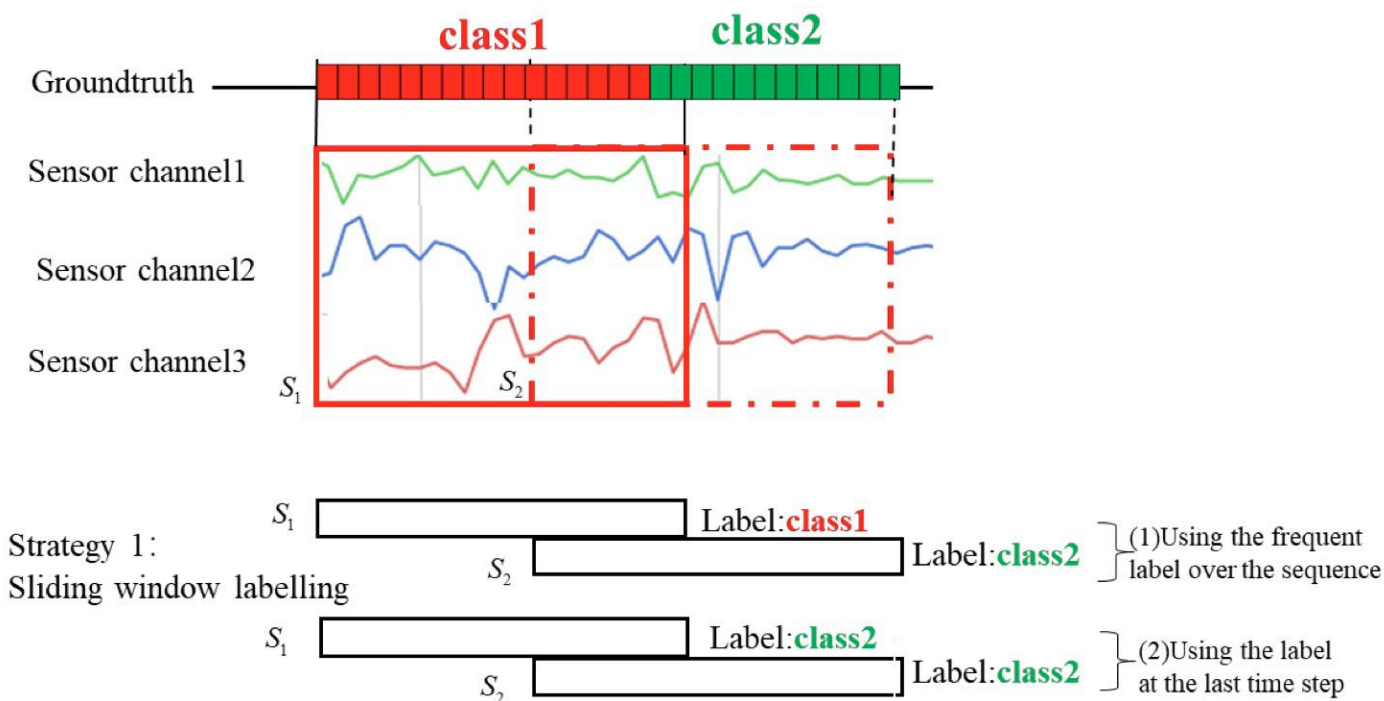
Windowing

- Choose a fix window size & an overlap (sliding step), e.g., 50%
- Preprocessing
 - Offline: global preprocessing
 - Online: window-based (no future data; past data discarded)



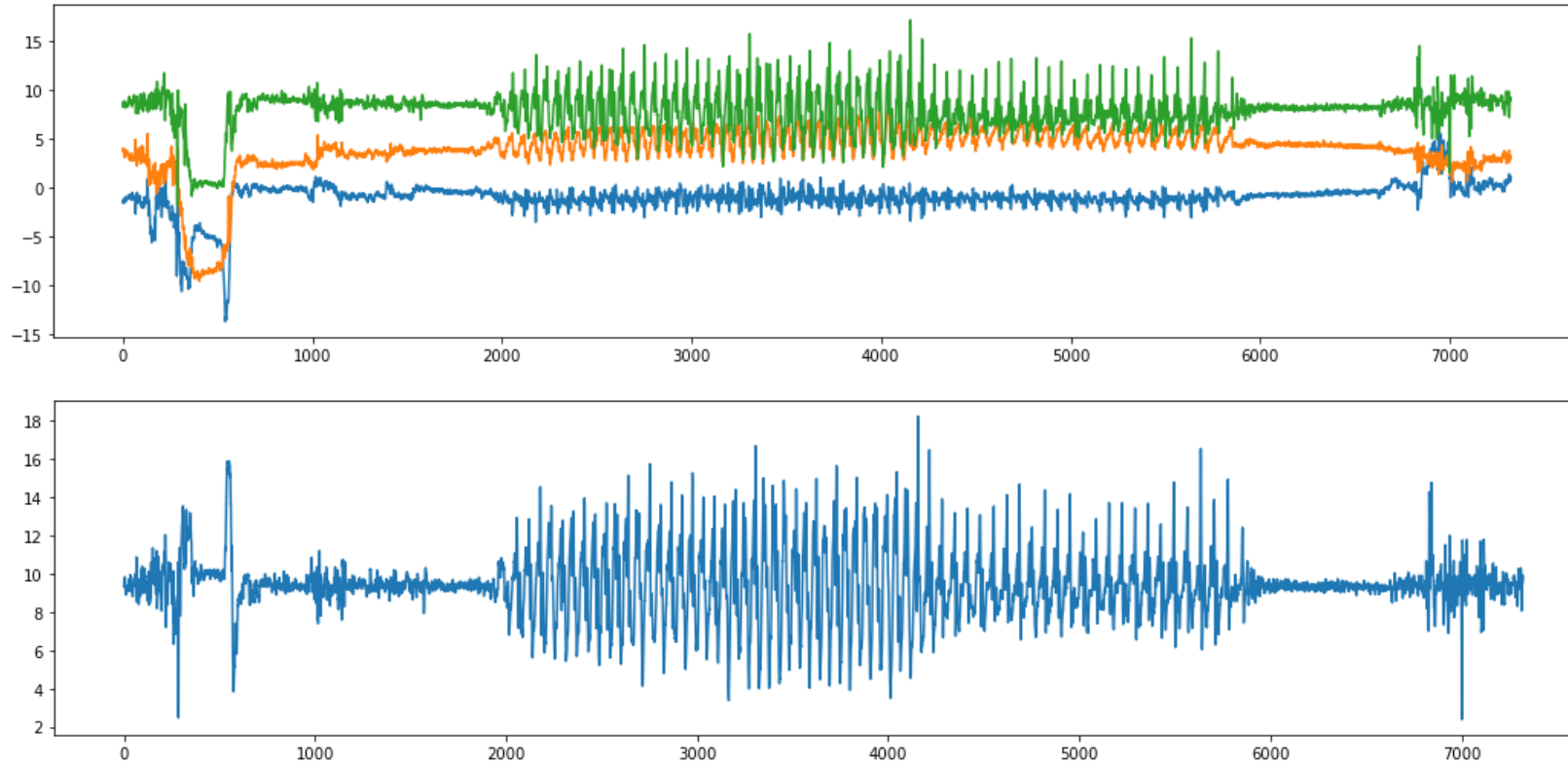
Labeling

- Mapping segments with classes



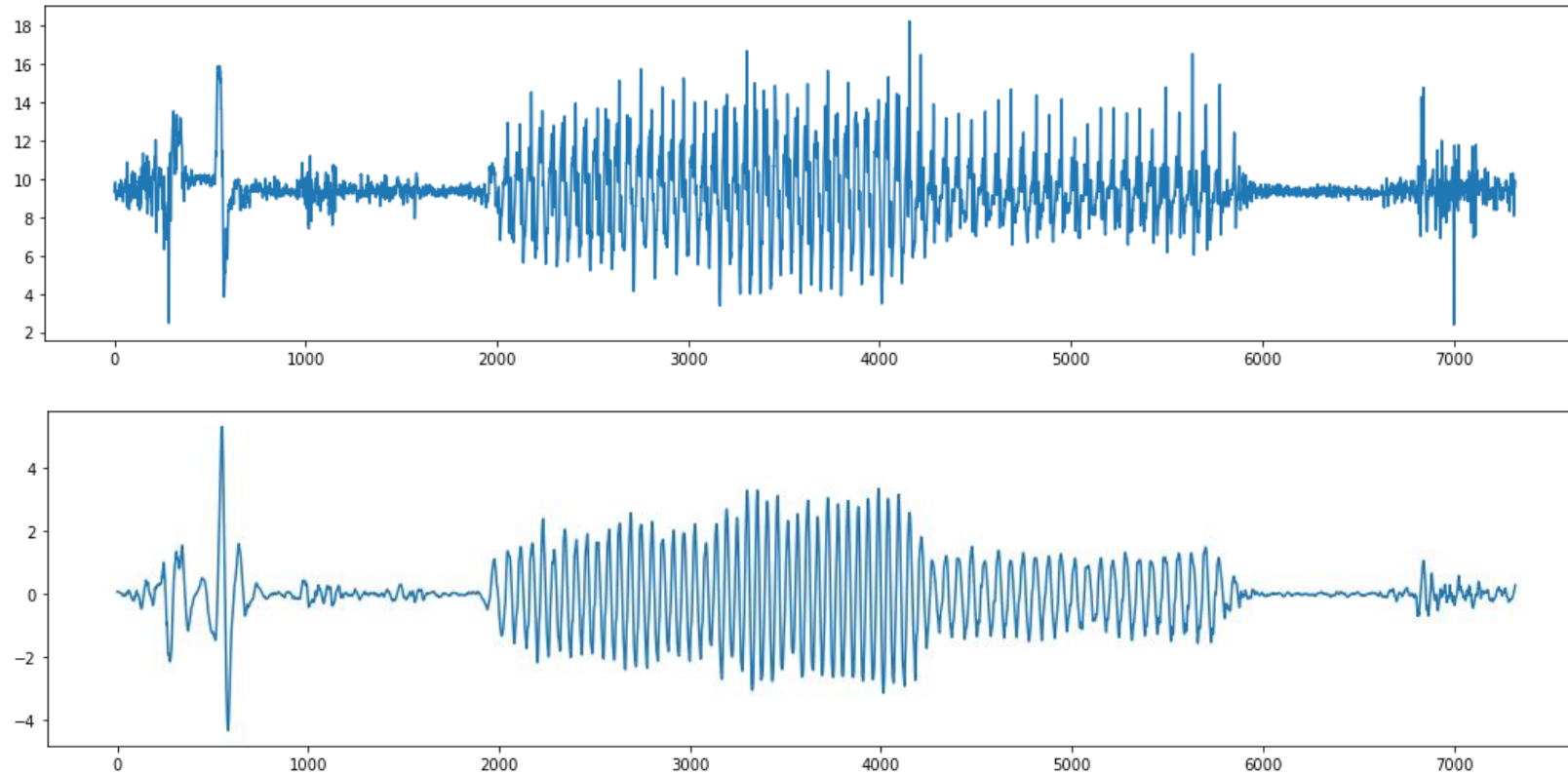
Coordinate Transformation

- (Where are) How to handle the 3-axis data?



$$\forall i: m_i = \sqrt{x^2 + y^2 + z^2}$$

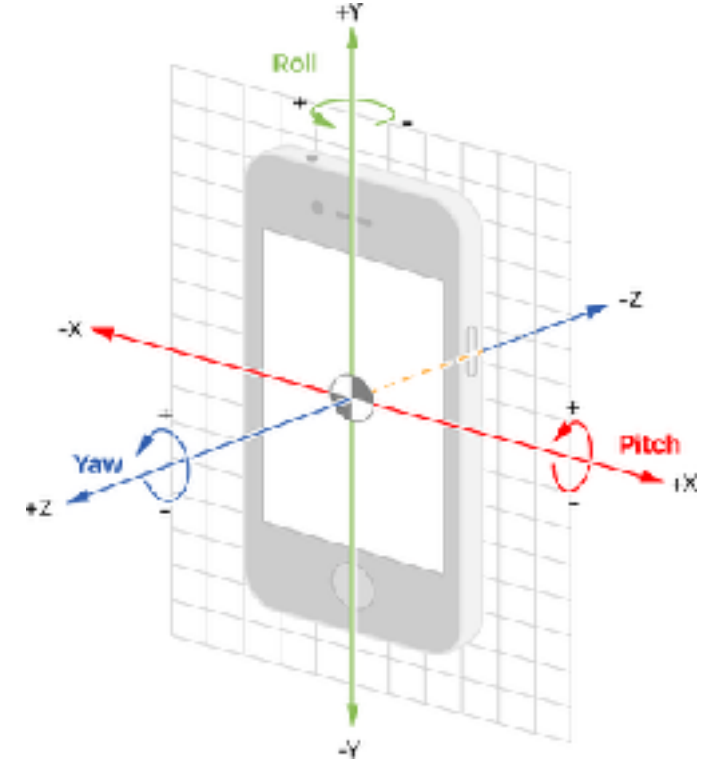
Gravitational and Body Force Separation



Gravity removal

Coordinate Transformation

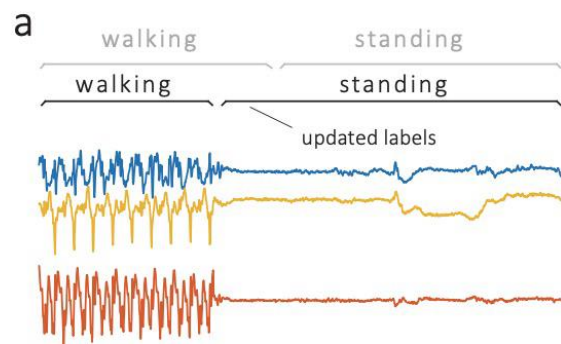
- Cartesian frame of reference (x,y,z)
- Rotations represented by Euler angles (yaw, pitch roll)
- Frames of reference
 - Local coordinate frame
 - Global coordinate frame
- Coordinate transformation
 - Rotation Matrix
 - (Euler angles)
 - (Quaternions)
 - Direct API available on mobile OS



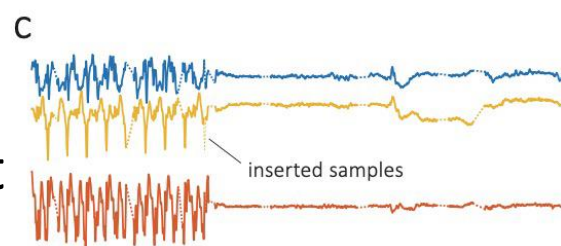
$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 \times 3 \\ \text{Rotation} \\ \text{Matrix} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \text{Initial Frame} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \text{Transformed Frame} \end{bmatrix}$$

Preprocessing

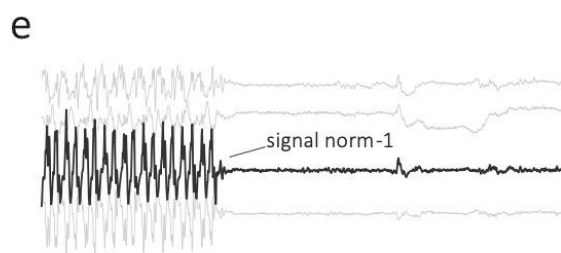
A: labels are
realigned (by eye)



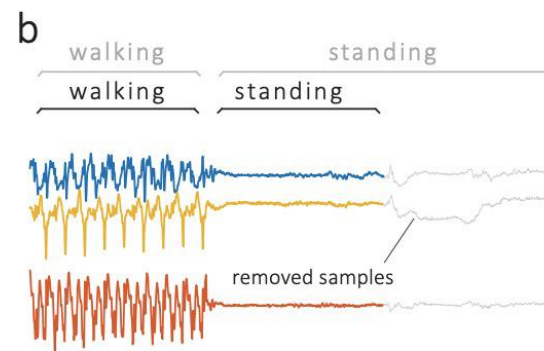
C: missing data is
filled with adjacent
data



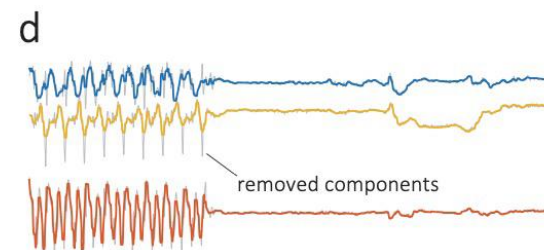
E: aggregation
(magnitude)



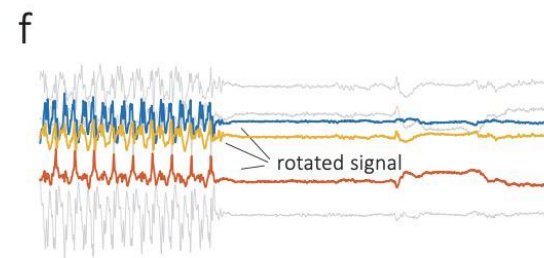
B: samples are removed
to balance data



D: removing components,
denoising: high frequency
noise cancellation

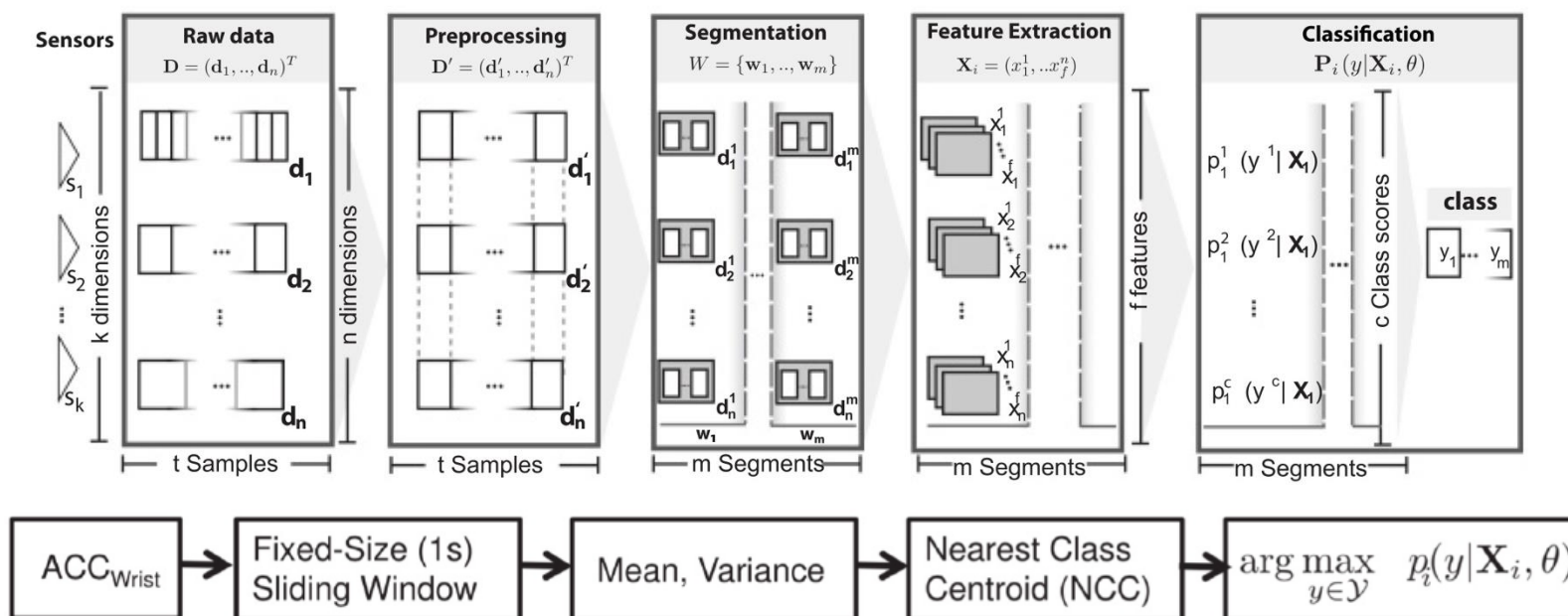


F: rotate to different
coordinate system

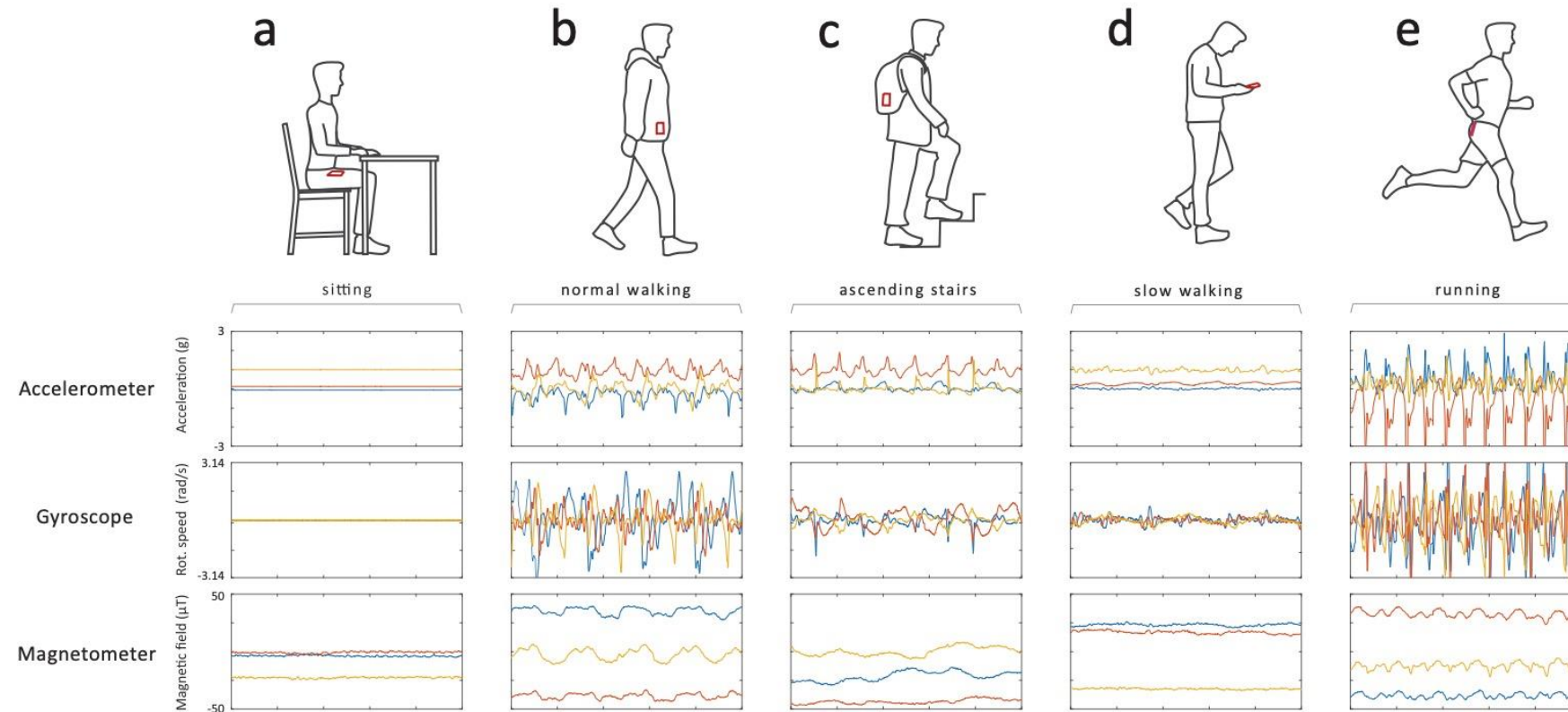


Segmented Samples to Prediction

- For each sample further analysis is applied to reach a prediction, for example:
 - Extract features on a sample and build a classifier to use them to decide on the class label for a sample



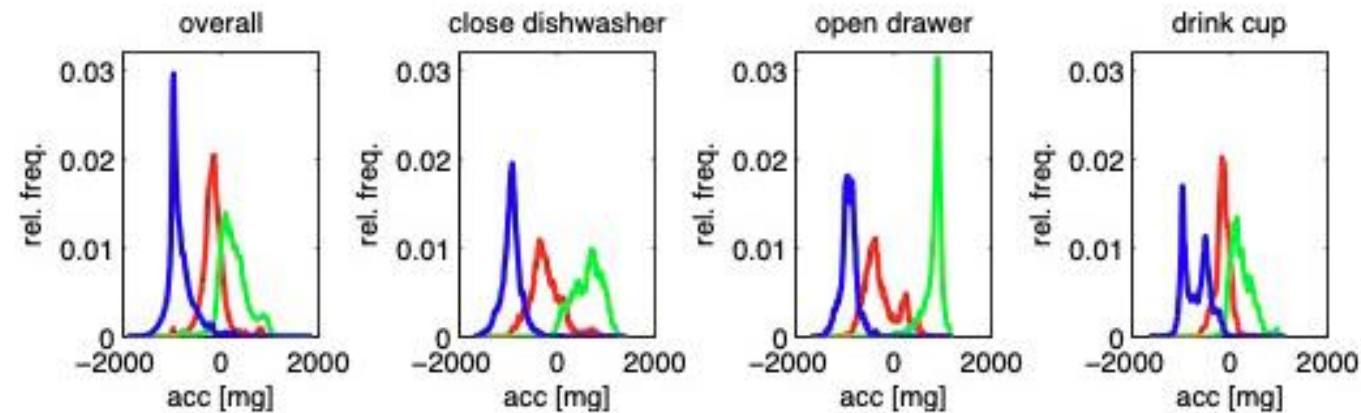
Human Activities Recognition



From A systematic review of smartphone-based human activity recognition methods for health research.
Marcin Straczewicz, Peter James, Jukka- Pekka Onnela. Nature NPJ Digital Medicine.

Classification

- Feature extraction produces a feature vector
 - Feature engineering: Manual (and more explainable) features
 - Deep learning: Automatic (yet less/not explainable) features
- Classification: Match a feature vector to a pre-defined set of classes



Distribution of x,y, z axis acceleration per window for various activities

Class Prediction Problem

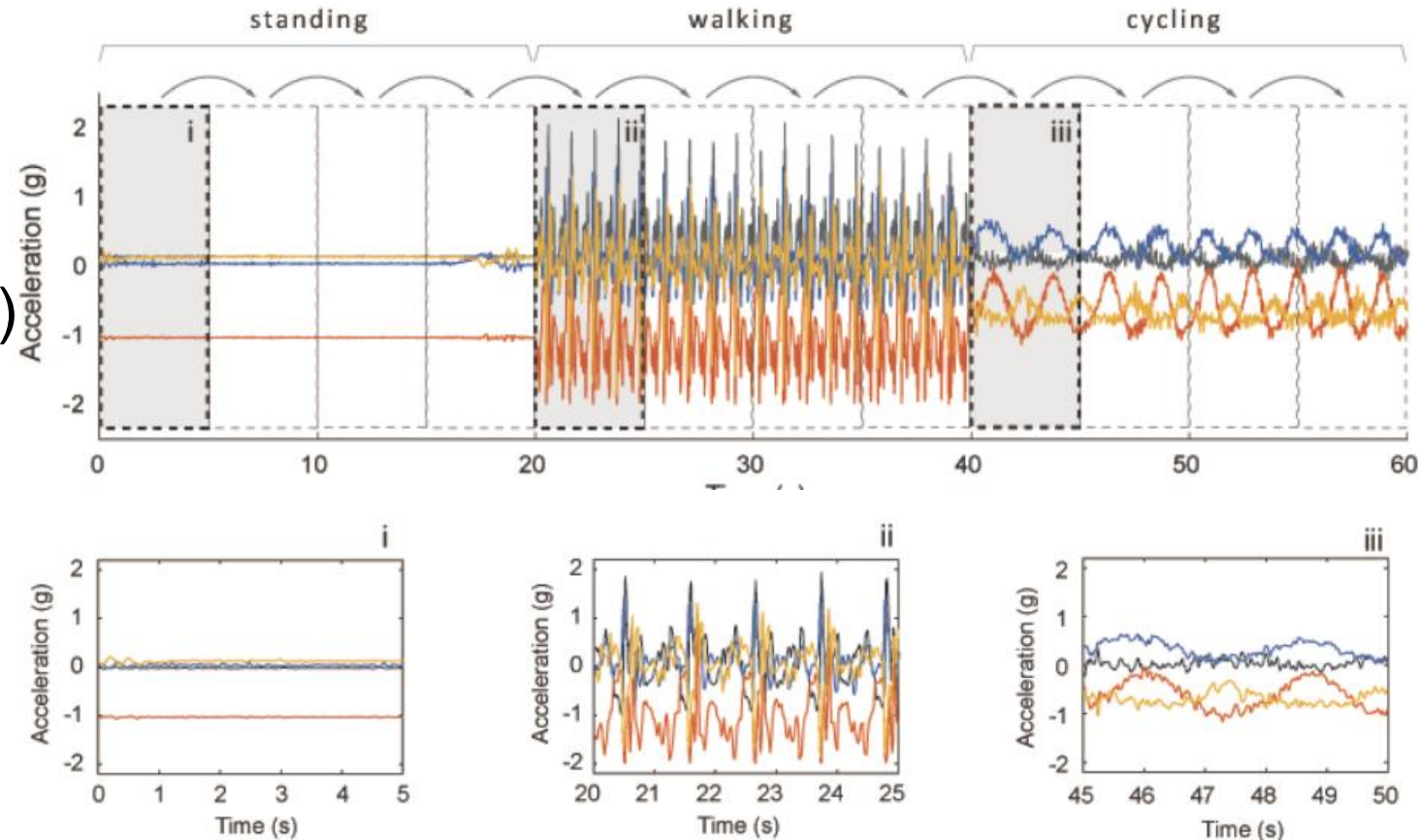
- Predict activity given a window of movement data.
- Predict activity given multiple windows of movement data.
- Predict the activity sequence given multiple windows of movement data.
- Predict activity given a sequence of movement data for a presegmented activity.
- Predict activity cessation or transition given a window of movement data.
- Predict a stationary or non-stationary activity given a window of movement data

Step 1: Data Preparation

- Activities: sitting, standing, waking, cycling

- Preprocessing:

- Filtered
- (Coordinates transformed)
- Gravity removed
- Segmented



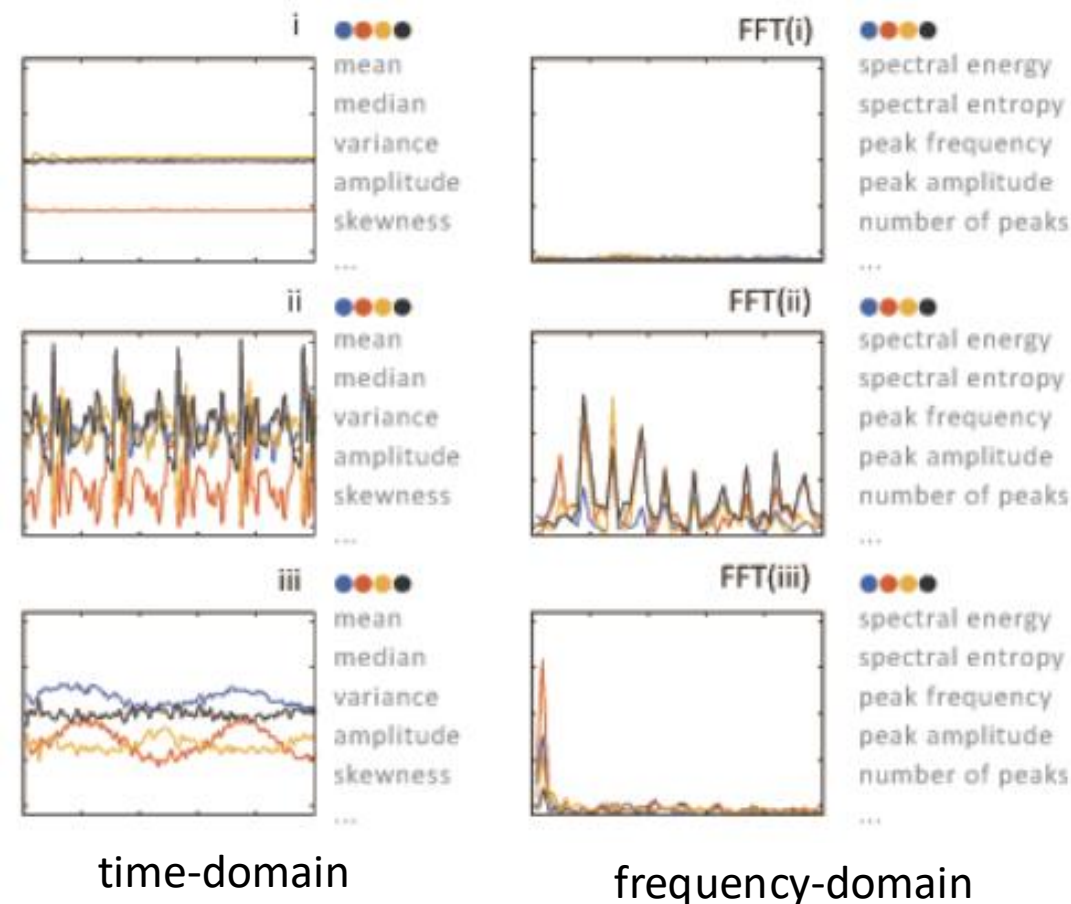
Step 2: Feature Extraction

- Feature Engineering

- Mean (can help distinguish between standing and sitting)
- Standard deviation
- Number of peaks (can help distinguish between waking and running)

- More possible features

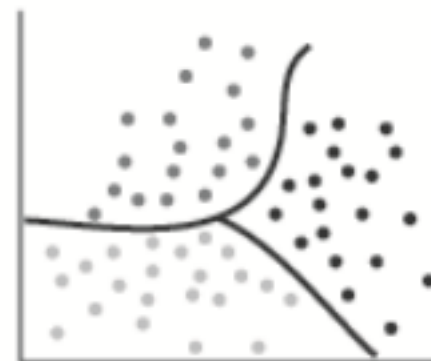
- median, skewness, kurtosis, max, min...
- Spectral energy/entropy, peak amplitude, #peaks, harmonic ratio...



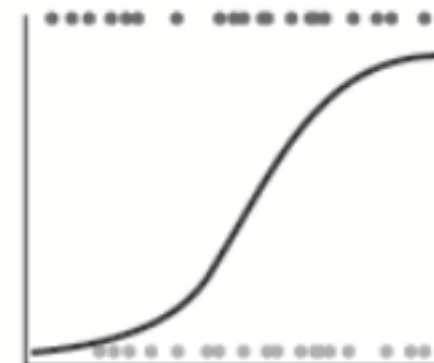
Step 3: Classification Model

- Classical machine learning

- K Nearest Neighbour
- Naïve Bayes classifier
- Decision Trees
- Hidden Markov Models
- Support Vector Machine



Logistic regression



Support vector machine

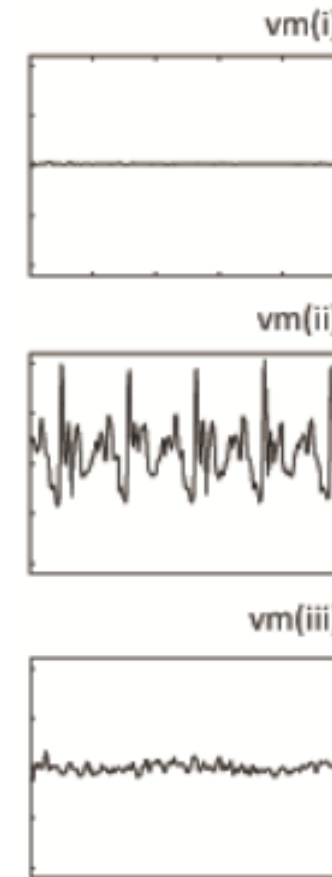


Random Forest

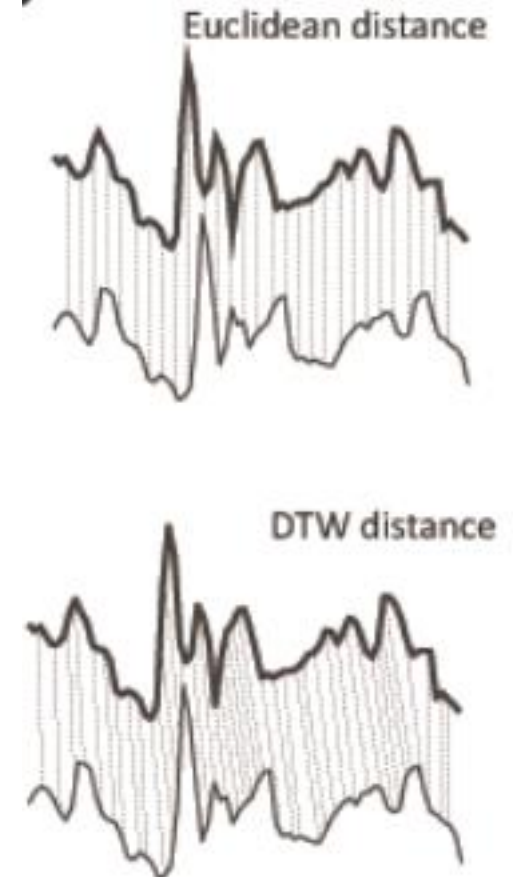


Step 2/3: Alternative (1)

- Segment serving as a template
 - May build from many segments/samples to reduce noise
- Template matching
 - Euclidean distance
 - Dynamic Time Warping (DTW)
 - EMD (Earth Mover's Distance)



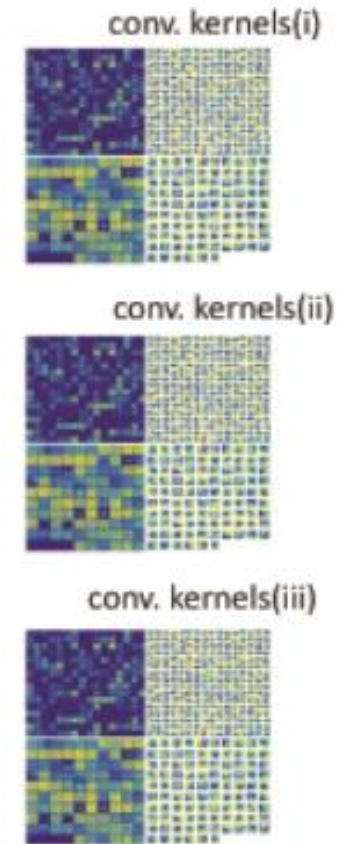
Activity template



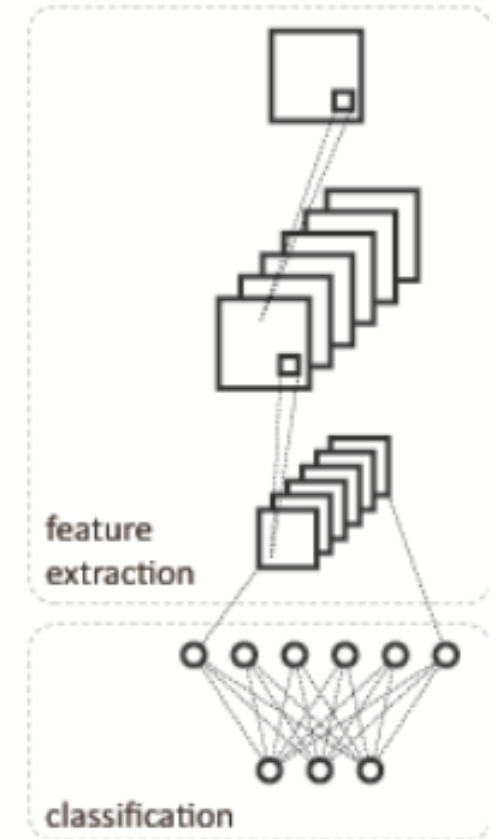
Template matching

Step 2/3: Alternative (2)

- Deep neural networks for feature extraction
 - Input segments into deep learning networks that compute high-dimensional deep/hidden features
- Deep learning models
 - CNN, RNN, GAN, Transformer...



“Deep” features



Deep learning

An HAR Example: Gait Analysis

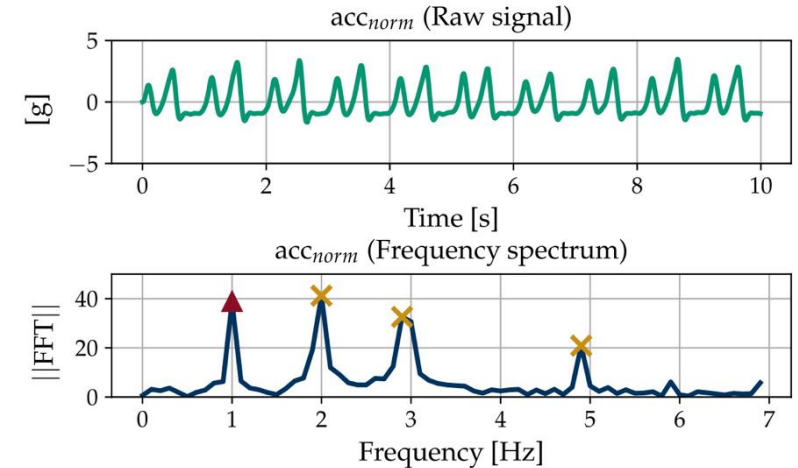
- Training set: 150 gait analysis recordings of 121 patients in hospital
- Validation set: 203 gait recordings from 7 PD patients at their home
- Exercises:
 - 1. 2x10 m walk with a break at the turning point (2x10m) 2)
 - 2. 4x10 m walk without stops at turning points
 - 3. (4x10m) 2-minute walk back and forth along a straight path of 25 m (2min)
 - 4. Tapping on the ground with the heel (heel)
 - 5. Tapping on the ground with heel and toes alternately (heel-toe)
 - 6. Circular movement of the foot (circling)



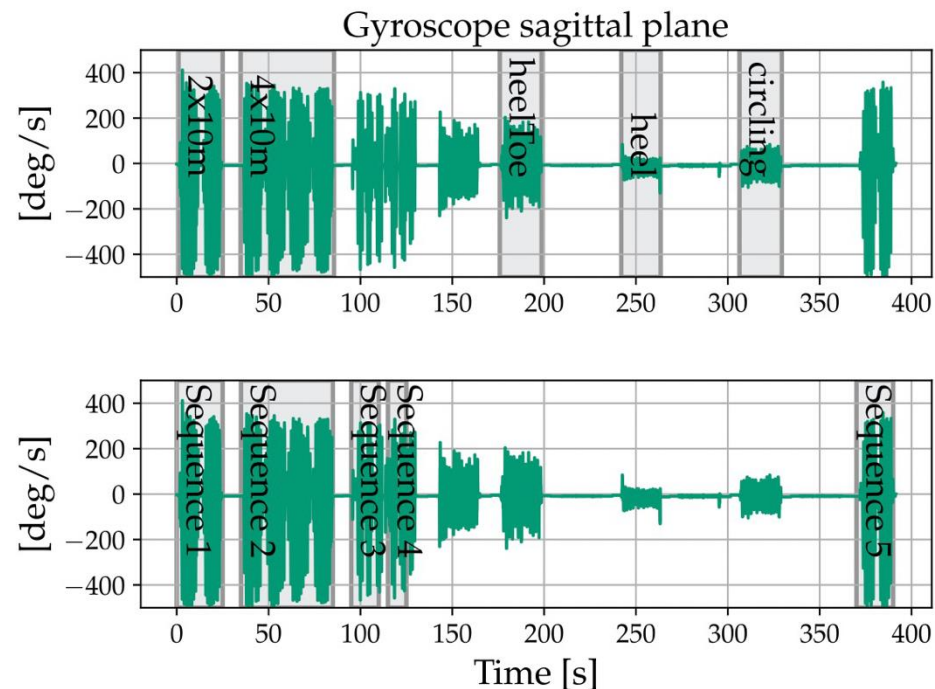
An HAR Example

- Norm of accelerometer and gyroscope for window used to detect movement. If above a threshold accept sequence.
- Low pass filter (cut off 6Hz).
- Use FFT to find important frequencies.
- Uses autocorrelation to measure peaks (and harmonic frequencies)
- Use these to decide if to keep this window.

$$|s^{3d}| = \sqrt{s_x^2 + s_y^2 + s_z^2},$$



Some results



	acc_v	acc_{norm}	gyr_{ml}	gyr_{norm}
Lab Data Set				
Sensitivity	0.97 (0.03)	0.94 (0.04)	0.98 (0.01)	0.89 (0.04)
Specificity	0.95 (0.02)	0.96 (0.01)	0.96 (0.02)	0.81 (0.04)
Youden index	0.92 (0.02)	0.90 (0.04)	0.94 (0.01)	0.70 (0.06)
Opt. Peak Prom.	8	13	17	11
Val. Data Set				
Sensitivity	0.50	0.70	0.97	0.89

Sensitivity: TPR of detecting existing gait

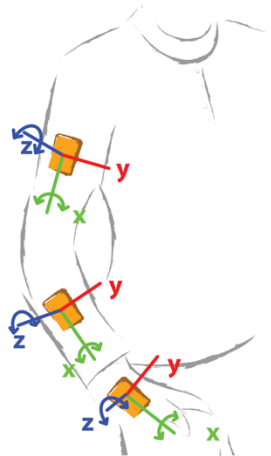
Specificity: TNR regarding the rejection of non-gait movements

acc_v : Acceleration along the vertical axis

gyr_{ml} : Rate of rotation around the medio-lateral axis

Another Example

- Confusion matrix



Activities

opening a window
closing a window
watering a plant
turning book pages
drinking from a bottle
cutting with a knife
chopping with a knife
stirring in a bowl
forehand
backhand
and smash

		classification												
		NULL	Open window	Drink	Water plant	Close window	Cut	Chop	Stir	Book	Forehand	Backhand	Smash	
groundtruth	NULL	24267	216	444	3228	48	24	60	75	45		3		recall
	Open window	3849	1938	453	291	48	12	9		24				85.42
	Drink	3984	927	3780	321	3	9							29.26
	Water plant	3984	726	774	3735	21	57	15						41.89
	Close window	3891	381	1173	945	1533								40.11
	Cut	2940		264	450		6585	456		3				19.35
	Chop	2895	168	435	153		909	5742		126				61.55
	Stir	4947	39	135	42	21	474	561	4392	207				55.06
	Book	4560	27	144	951		354	1725	60	6687				40.60
	Forehand	3195	330		144	609	9	66		3	969	6	3	46.09
	Backhand	3003	207	21		21	3	6	24	33		1302		18.17
	Smash	1860	57		78	185		42	45		1567	137	230	28.18
precision		38.29	38.64	49.59	36.13	61.59	78.06	66.14	95.56	93.81	38.21	89.92	98.71	5.47

LLM for Mobile Sensing

- LLMs Understand Sensor Data!
- LLMs Generate Sensor Data!

IMUGPT 2.0: Language-Based Cross Modality Transfer for Sensor-Based Human Activity Recognition

ZIKANG LI
AMITRAJIT
HRUDHAI
LIZHE ZHANG
ELIZABETH
HYEOKHYUN
THOMAS

SENSORLLM: ALIGNING LARGE LANGUAGE MODELS WITH MOTION SENSORS FOR HUMAN ACTIVITY RECOGNITION

Zechen Li¹, Shohreh Deldari¹,

¹University of New South Wales,

²University of Tokyo

Large Language Models Memorize Sensor Datasets! Implications on Human Activity Recognition Research

Harish Haresamudram
Georgia Institute of Technology
Atlanta, USA

Nikhil Murlidhar Shanmugam
Georgia Institute of Technology
Atlanta, USA

LLaSA: Large Multimodal Agent for Human Activity Analysis Through Wearable Sensors

Sheikh Asif Imran, Mohammad Nur Hossain Khan, Subrata Biswas, Bashima Islam

Worcester Polytechnic Institute

Worcester, USA

simran@wpi.edu, mkhan@wpi.edu, sbiswas@wpi.edu, bislam@wpi.edu

Foundation Models

Google Research Google DeepMind

2024-10-03

Scaling Wearable Foundation Models

Girish Narayanswamy^{o,1}, Xin Liu^{o,†,1}, Kumar Ayush¹, Yuzhe Yang¹, Xuhai Xu¹, Shun Liao¹, Jake Garrison¹, Shyam Tailor¹, Jake Sunshine¹, Yun Liu¹, Tim Althoff¹, Shrikanth Narayanan¹, Pushmeet Kohli², Jiening Zhan¹, Mark Malhotra¹, Shwetak Patel¹, Samy Abdel-Ghaffar¹ and Daniel McDuff^{†,1}

^oCo-first, [†]Corresponding Author, ¹Google Research, ²Google DeepMind

Wearable sensors have become ubiquitous thanks to a variety of health tracking features. The resulting continuous and longitudinal measurements from everyday life generate large volumes of data; however, making sense of these observations for scientific and actionable insights is non-trivial. Inspired by the empirical success of generative modeling, where large neural networks learn powerful representations from vast amounts of text, image, video, or audio data, we investigate the scaling properties of sensor foundation models across compute, data, and model size. Using a dataset of up to 40 million hours of in-situ heart rate, heart rate variability, electrodermal activity, accelerometer, skin temperature, and altimeter per-minute data from over 165,000 people, we create LSM, a multimodal foundation model built on the largest wearable-signals dataset with the most extensive range of sensor modalities to date. Our results establish the scaling laws of LSM for tasks such as imputation, interpolation and extrapolation, both across time and sensor modalities. Moreover, we highlight how LSM enables sample-efficient downstream learning for tasks like exercise and activity recognition.

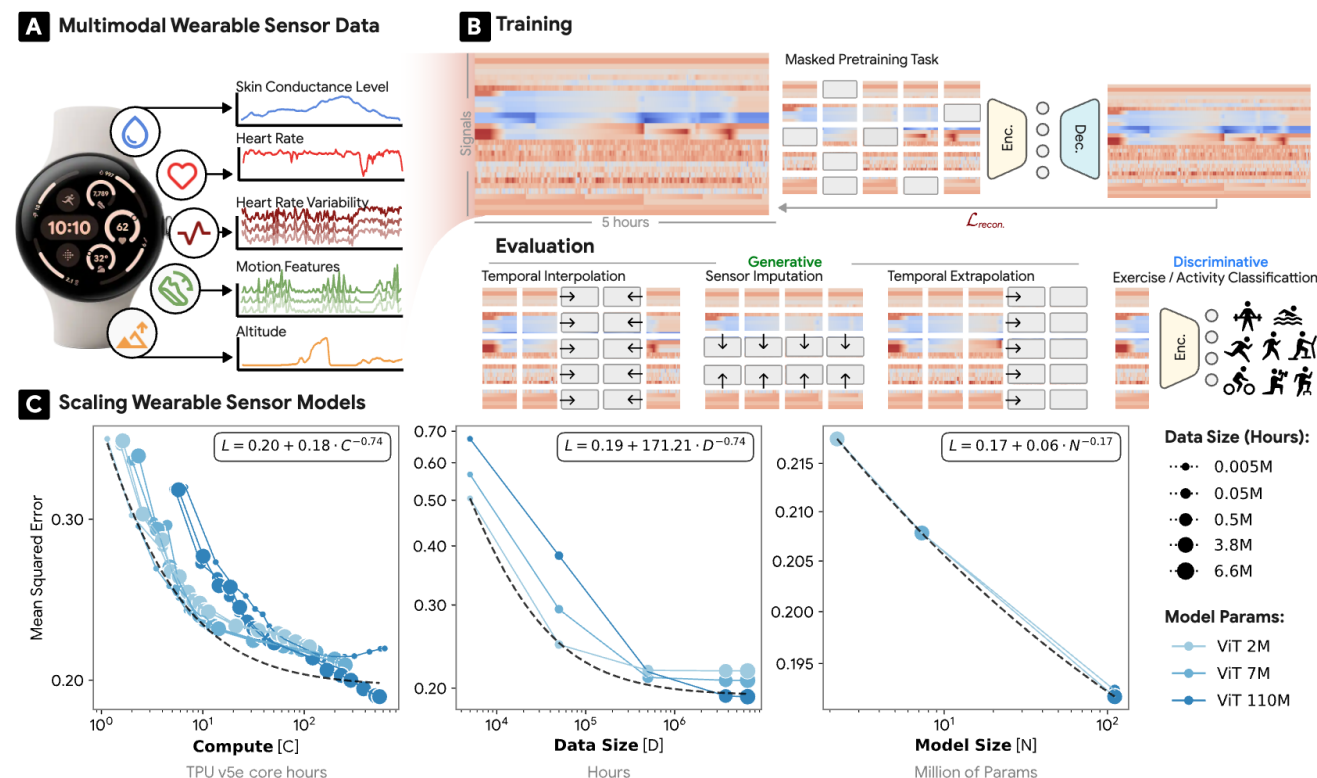
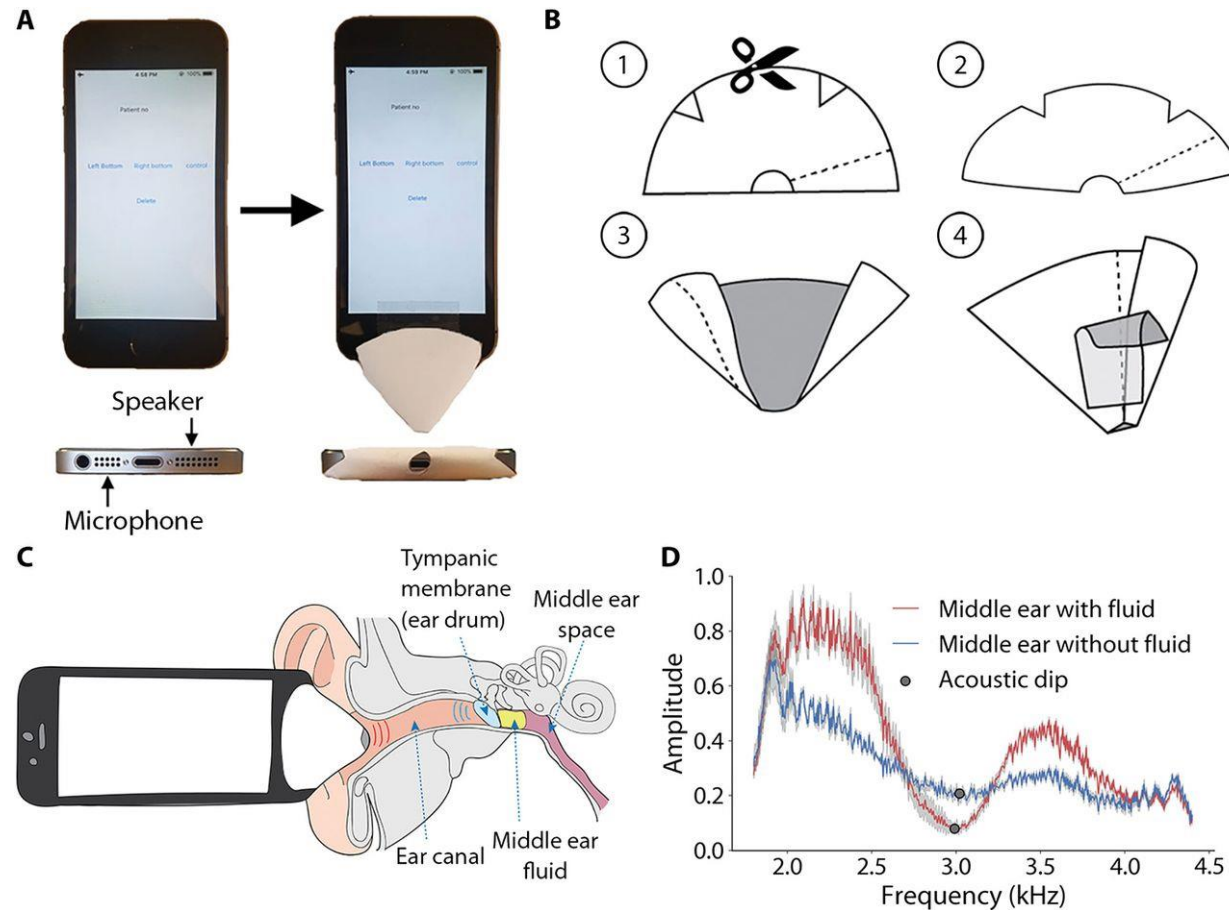


Figure 1 | **Scaling foundation models on wearable data.** Making sense of physiological and behavioral signals derived from wearables is challenging. (A) We present a systematic scaling analysis of sensor models using up to 40 million hours of multimodal data from over 165,000 people. (B) Using a random masking pretext task, we evaluate on tasks of imputation, forecasting, and downstream classification. (C) Experiments show scaling compute, data, and model size are all effective. Scaling is shown on the random imputation task.

More Applications of Mobile Sensing

- So many innovative applications, built upon a combination of various sensors
- Mobile Health
- Interaction
- Transportation

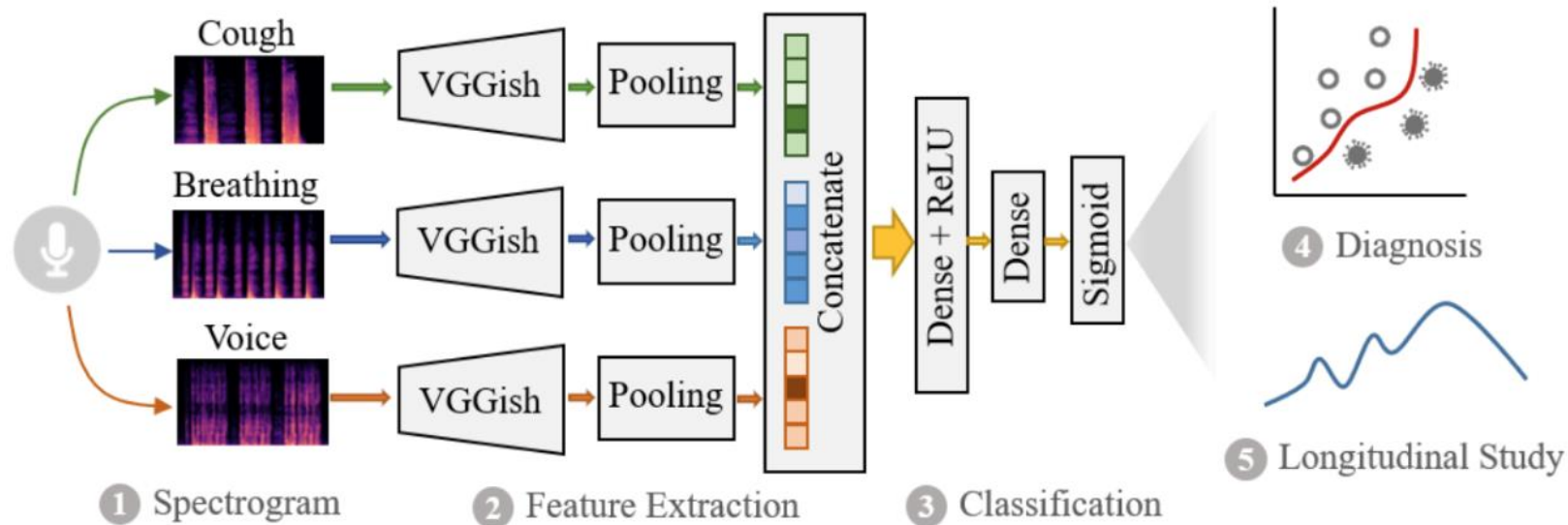
Middle ear fluid detection



Chan, Justin, et al. "Detecting middle ear fluid using smartphones." *Science translational medicine* 11.492 (2019): eaav1102.

COVID-19 Detection

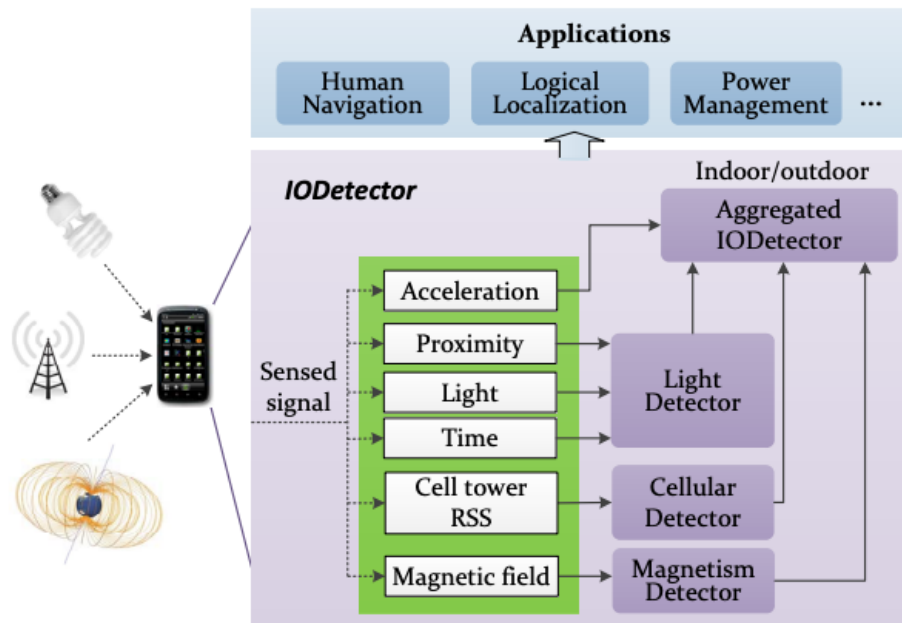
- Data analysis over a large-scale crowdsourced dataset of respiratory sounds collected to aid diagnosis of COVID-19.



Brown, Chloë, et al. "Exploring automatic diagnosis of COVID-19 from crowdsourced respiratory sound data." *arXiv preprint arXiv:2006.05919* (2020).

Indoor/Outdoor Detection

- IODetector: Indoor/Outdoor detection service
 - Adopted to support the real world business of on-demand food delivery.

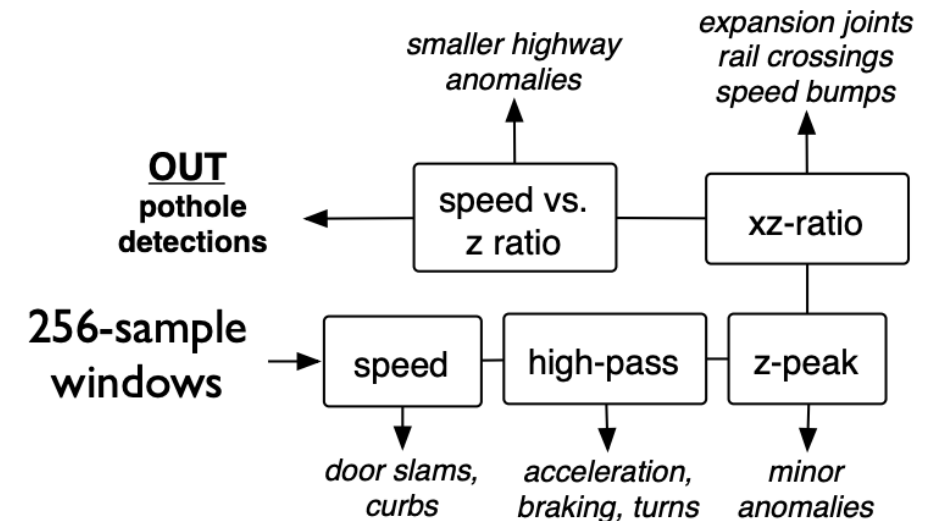


The Pothole Patrol

- uses the inherent mobility of the participating vehicles, opportunistically gathering data from vibration and GPS sensors, and processing the data to assess road surface conditions.



pothole v. not pothole



Eriksson, Jakob, et al. "The pothole patrol: using a mobile sensor network for road surface monitoring." *Proceedings of the 6th international conference on Mobile systems, applications, and services*. 2008.

Questions?

- Thank you!